WIKIPEDIA
25 years of the free encyclopedia

Tetris

Tetris (Russian: Тетрис)[b] is a puzzle video game created by Alexey Pajitnov, a Soviet software engineer, in the mid-1980s. In *Tetris*, falling pieces consisting of four connected blocks, known as tetrominoes, must be sorted into a pile. Once a horizontal line of the playfield is filled with blocks, the line disappears, granting points and preventing the pile from reaching the top. This gameplay has been used in approximately 220 versions across at least 70 platforms. Newer versions frequently add game mechanics, some of which have become standard.

Tetris



Logo since 2019

Genre	Puzzle
Creator	Alexey Pajitnov
Platforms	Various (70 or more)
First release	*Tetris* (Spectrum HoloByte) January 27, 1988[a]
Latest release	*Tetris: The Grand Master 4 – Absolute Eye* April 4, 2025

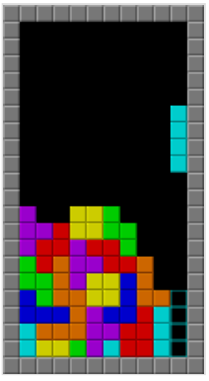
In the mid-1980s, Pajitnov created *Tetris* in his spare time while working at the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center of the Academy of Sciences. He initially programmed it in Pascal for the Elektronika 60 in about three weeks, then spent over two months porting it to the IBM PC using Turbo Pascal with help from Dmitry Pavlovsky and Vadim Gerasimov. Floppy disk copies were distributed freely throughout Moscow before spreading to Eastern Europe. Robert Stein of Andromeda Software saw *Tetris* in Hungary and contacted the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center to secure a license to release it commercially. Stein sublicensed it to Mirrorsoft in the UK and Spectrum HoloByte in the US. Both companies released *Tetris* in 1988 to commercial success and sublicensed to additional companies, including Henk Rogers' Bullet-Proof Software. Rogers negotiated with Elektronorgtechnica, the state-owned organization in charge of licensing Soviet software, to license *Tetris* to Nintendo for the Game Boy and Nintendo Entertainment System (NES); both versions were released in 1989.

With 35 million sales as of June 2024, the Game Boy version is the highest-selling version. It contributed to the Game Boy's success and popularized *Tetris*. At the end of 1995, Dorodnitsyn Computing Center's rights to *Tetris*, arranged ten years prior, reverted to Pajitnov. The Tetris Company was established to manage rights and licensing. It created guidelines and a minimum specification for licensed *Tetris* games. Certain features not in the original games became standardized over time. Versions of *Tetris* were released on mobile devices starting in the 2000s, with Electronic Arts holding a license on such ports from 2006 to 2020, to commercial success. *Tetris* received renewed popularity in the late-2010s with the release of the critically successful *Tetris Effect* (2018) and *Tetris 99* (2019).

Tetris is the best-selling video game of all time,[c] having sold 520 million copies as of December 2024. It is frequently cited as one of the greatest and most influential games, and was among the inaugural class inducted into the World Video Game Hall of Fame in 2015. Its gameplay has been influential in the genre of puzzle video games, being cited as an early example of casual gaming. Furthermore, *Tetris* has been represented in a vast array of media such as architecture and art and been the subject of academic research, including studies of its potential for psychological intervention. A competitive culture has formed around *Tetris*, particularly the NES version, with players – typically adolescents – competing at the annual Classic Tetris World Championship. A film dramatization of its development was released in 2023.

Gameplay

Across its numerous versions, *Tetris* generally has a consistent puzzle video game design.[1] Gameplay consists of a rectangular field in which pieces consisting of four connected blocks, called tetrominoes,[d] descend one at a time from the top-center. During the descent, the player can move the piece horizontally and rotate it until it touches the bottom of the field or another piece.[3][4] The player's goal is to stack the pieces in the field to create horizontal lines of blocks.[5] When a line is completed, it disappears and the blocks placed above fall one row. The speed of the descending pieces increases as lines are cleared. The game ends if the accumulated pieces in the field block other pieces from entering the field, a process known as "topping out".[4] Common mechanics among *Tetris* versions include the queue (viewing the pieces that are next to appear), soft drop (increasing the descent of the piece), hard drop (instantly placing the piece as far down as it can go), and holding (reserving a piece for later use).[5]



A typical *Tetris* game screen

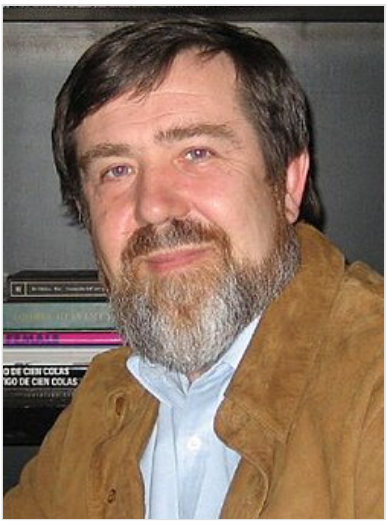
The objective of *Tetris* is to collect as many points as possible during a gameplay session by clearing lines.[3] *Tetris*'s scoring system has remained mostly consistent since *Tetris DS* (2006) with some exceptions. Points gained during gameplay increase with the descent speed. The more lines cleared at once, the higher the score for a line clear. Completing four horizontal lines at once by placing an I-shaped tetromino into a single-column gap is referred to as a "Tetris"; most versions award the highest score for it. The player can also gain points by using hard drops or soft drops.[5] Advanced techniques, often used in competitive play, include T-spins (spinning a T-shaped tetromino into a blocked gap), perfect clears (emptying the field following a line clear), and combos (clearing lines consecutively).[6]

History

Creation (1984–1985)

Alexey Pajitnov was a speech recognition and artificial intelligence researcher at the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center of the Academy of Sciences.[7] While at the center, he developed more than twenty types of games in his spare time[8]:72 on the Elektronika 60,[9] a Russian clone of the PDP-11 computer.[10] He became inspired to convert pentomino tiling puzzles to the computer[11] after he bought

a pentomino puzzle set from a store and played with it in his office.[12] Sources vary on the exact timing: certain sources indicate June 1984,[11] while the BBC documentary *Tetris: From Russia with Love* (2004) suggests spring 1985.[13]



Alexey Pajitnov (pictured in 2008), the creator of *Tetris*

Pajitnov programmed *Tetris* using Pascal for the RT-11 operating system on the Elektronika 60[14] and experimented with different versions.[15] Because the Elektronika 60 had no graphical interface, Pajitnov modeled the field and pieces using spaces and brackets.[15] He felt that the game would be needlessly complicated with the twelve different shapes of pentominoes, so he scaled the concept down to tetrominoes, of which there are only seven shapes.[11] Afterward, he programmed the basic mechanics, including the ability to flip tetrominoes as they fell in a vertical screen and the clearing of lines.[11][16][17] The name *Tetris* was a combination of "tetra" (meaning "four") and Pajitnov's favorite sport, tennis.[18][19]

Pajitnov completed the first version of *Tetris*, though sources differ on the timeline. In a 1993 interview with the Japanese magazine *The Super Famicom*, he recalled that the game was finished in 1985 and said it took about three weeks to develop due to its simplicity,[8]:72 while Henk Rogers reported in 2024 that Pajitnov recalled first developing it on the Elektronika 60 in 1984.[20] This version had no scoring system and no levels,[21] but it nonetheless captivated Pajitnov's peers,[22][23] some of whom obtained copies of the completed code to run on their compatible work computers.[24]

Pajitnov sought to port *Tetris* to the IBM Personal Computer (IBM PC), which had a higher-quality display than the Elektronika 60. He recruited his colleague Dmitry Pavlovsky and the 16-year-old computer prodigy Vadim Gerasimov.[25][26] Using Turbo Pascal,[14] the three adapted *Tetris* to the IBM PC over two months, with Gerasimov incorporating color and Pavlovsky incorporating a scoreboard.[25][27] Floppy disk copies of this version were distributed freely throughout the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center, before spreading quickly among Moscow computer circles.[28] Pajitnov kept note of second-hand accounts of *Tetris*'s spread during this time.[29] *Tetris* reportedly won second place in a Zelenodolsk computer game competition in November 1985,[25] and by 1986, nearly everyone with an IBM computer in Moscow and several major cities had played *Tetris*.[30]

Spread beyond the Soviet Union (1985–1988)

Under Soviet copyright law, intellectual rights were not well protected, and the state-run organization Elektronorgtechnica (Elorg) had a monopoly on the import and export of software.[31] Around this time, Pajitnov arranged for the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center to have the rights to *Tetris* for ten years to ease potential legal troubles.[32] As a result, Pajitnov could not sell *Tetris* for profit. Nonetheless, Pajitnov's manager Victor Brjabrin liked *Tetris* and sought opportunities for success beyond the Soviet Union.[33][34] In early 1986, Brjabrin sent a copy of *Tetris* to the SZKI Institute of Computer Studies in Budapest.[33][34] Robert Stein,



The first version of *Tetris*, developed for the Elektronika 60 in the mid-1980s, is shown here running in emulation.

founder of Andromeda Software who profited by licensing software from Hungary to UK companies, encountered *Tetris* during a visit to the SZKI Institute and found its gameplay compelling.[35] Stein learned from the SZKI Institute director that a researcher there, Gábor Bolgár, had ported *Tetris* to the Commodore 64.[36] Stein returned to London and contacted Dorodnitsyn Computing Center by telex to obtain the license rights, believing he could sell those rights to a larger UK publisher.[37]

Brjabrin received the telex and, after translating it from English to Russian, disclosed it to Pajitnov, who spent days attempting to compose, translate to English, and send a favorable yet noncommittal response by telex to Stein. Despite this attempt, Stein interpreted the response as granting him the license and proceeded to find a publisher for *Tetris*.[38] Stein pitched *Tetris* to Jim Mackonochie of Mirrorsoft, a UK software company founded by business magnate Robert Maxwell and Mackonochie. Though Mackonochie was skeptical about the commercial potential of *Tetris*, he consulted Phil Adam, president of US sister company Spectrum HoloByte, for his input. During his overseas visit to Mirrorsoft, Adam played *Tetris* for hours and then encouraged Mackonochie to accept Stein's offer. Though still cautious, Mackonochie agreed to allow himself the licensing rights for Europe and Adam the rights for the United States and Japan.[39] Stein sold the rights to the two companies for £3,000 and royalties of 7.5–15% of sales, even though negotiations with the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center were at a standstill, with the Dorodnitsyn Computing Center being resistant to selling *Tetris* in the West.[40]

Gilman Louie, CEO of Spectrum HoloByte, sought to exoticize the game's Soviet origins, marketing it as the first Soviet product to be sold in North America, alongside implementing Soviet folk music and imagery during gameplay and using red packaging adorned with an illustration of Saint Basil's Cathedral.[41][42] *Tetris* was first commercially released in the West for the IBM PC, with ports to other computer systems planned for release in the following weeks. Mirrorsoft released the game in the United Kingdom on January 27, 1988,[43] and Spectrum HoloByte released it in the United States on January 29, 1988.[44] Gábor Bolgár sold his Commodore 64 port to Stein's Andromeda Software, who polished it with additional sound work before licensing it to Mirrorsoft.[45] Mirrorsoft rewrote the code of the original IBM release for systems such as the Amiga and Atari ST.[46] Boosted by word of mouth and positive reviews,[47][48] this *Tetris* release was commercially successful, selling 100 thousand copies within a year.[49] At the Software Publishers Association's Excellence in Software Awards ceremony in 1989, *Tetris* won across three categories.[50]

At the time, the only document certifying a license fee was the telex from Pajitnov and Brjabrin, meaning that Stein had sold the license for a game he did not yet own. Additionally, Alexander Alexinko, director of Elorg, discovered Stein's negotiations with Pajitnov and Dorodnitsyn Computing Center and assessed their communications with disapproval. In response, Elorg took over representing the Soviet Union in negotiations.[51] Through communications, Alexinko attempted to revoke any potential deal the Soviet Union might have had with Stein in favor of having Elorg itself sell *Tetris* internationally. Stein responded by threatening to create a scandal that would harm the Soviet Union's international standing, persuading Alexinko to consider negotiating the rights to *Tetris*.[52] An agreement was drafted by the end of February 1988 and finalized by May, granting Stein the rights to *Tetris* on computers.[53][52]

International negotiations (1988–1989)

Following the commercial release of *Tetris*, Spectrum HoloByte and Mirrorsoft started licensing the game to other companies for platforms that were not covered by the contract that Stein and Elorg had agreed to.[54] At the time, Henk Rogers had been seeking video games across the world to sell in Japan through

his company Bullet-Proof Software; he discovered *Tetris* as a publicly displayed video game at the 1988 Winter Consumer Electronics Show (CES).[55] Mirrorsoft sold Atari Games subsidiary Tengen the rights to sell non-computer releases of *Tetris* in Japan in exchange for the rights to sell computer ports of *Blasteroids* worldwide.[56] Afterward, Tengen sold the Japanese arcade rights to Sega and the console rights to Rogers, who received the Japanese computer rights from Spectrum HoloByte.[57][58] Bullet-Proof Software released *Tetris* for Japanese computers in November 1988[59]:88 and Nintendo's Family Computer (Famicom) in December 1988, the latter of which became commercially successful, selling two million copies in Japan.[60] Despite this, Elorg was unaware of the Famicom version and was receiving no royalties from *Tetris*'s worldwide success.[61][62]



Henk Rogers (pictured in 2010), representing Nintendo, negotiated with Elorg for the rights to *Tetris*.

Around the time of *Tetris*'s Famicom version, Nintendo developed the Game Boy, an economical handheld game console that interested Nintendo president Hiroshi Yamauchi and Nintendo of America president Minoru Arakawa.[63] Arakawa, aided by Nintendo of America vice president Howard Lincoln, sought to port *Tetris* to the Game Boy, believing that it would be a commercial success. They were both discouraged by the convoluted nature of the game's legal rights, leading Arakawa to enlist Rogers in getting the handheld rights to *Tetris*.[64] Rogers contacted Stein by fax in November 15, 1988, for the handheld rights, with Stein responding that he was negotiating them with Elorg. At the time, Alexinko had been replaced by the more adversarial Evgeni Belikov as director of Elorg. After failing to get the rights after multiple attempts at contacting Stein, Rogers abandoned him in favor of negotiating directly with the Soviet government.[65] In February 1989, Rogers traveled to the Soviet Union and arrived at the Elorg offices uninvited to negotiate the rights. Discussions with Rogers were scheduled the next day.[66]

While trying to persuade Elorg to grant him the handheld rights, Rogers displayed a Famicom *Tetris* cartridge to demonstrate the game's success. Belikov did not recognize the cartridge, believing that the rights to *Tetris* had only been signed for computer systems per the contract with Stein, and accused Rogers of illegal publication.[67][68] Though surprised, Rogers provided a check of over $40,000 to Elorg as to remedy this breach of contract and discussed granting him the console rights. Afterward, Belikov recognized the potential financial benefits of allying with Rogers over the other incoming negotiators: Stein and Robert's son Kevin Maxwell.[69] While Rogers was consulting Nintendo for a potential offer to Elorg, Belikov implicitly diminished Stein and Kevin's standing in subsequent meetings by coercing the former into signing an updated contract with an exclusionary definition of computers and baiting the latter into admitting that Mirrorsoft did not have the console rights, unaware of the commercial Famicom release.[70] Rogers, alongside Arakawa and Lincoln, returned to Moscow, and after a few days of negotiation, Nintendo received both the handheld and console rights to *Tetris* from Elorg.[71]

Legal battles and aftermath (1989–1993)

On March 31, 1989, taking advantage of the new agreement, Lincoln sent a cease and desist fax to Hideyuki Nakajima, president of Atari Games, concerning their subsidiary Tengen's production of *Tetris* for the Nintendo Entertainment System (NES), the North American equivalent to the Famicom.[72] Believing themselves to own the console rights to *Tetris*, Tengen filed copyright applications for the game

in the United States and preemptively sued Nintendo.[73][72] Meanwhile, after being informed by Kevin, Robert pressured Elorg for sidestepping prior agreements with his companies by contacting ministers from both the Soviet and UK governments.[74] In an in-person meeting, Robert informed Soviet General Secretary Mikhail Gorbachev of his situation regarding *Tetris*, to which he responded that Robert "should no longer worry about the Japanese company".[75][76] Despite pressure from both Robert and the Soviet government, Belikov stated his refusal to concede in a conversation with Lincoln.[77]



Tetris running on a Nintendo Game Boy

After a marketing campaign ordered by Nakajima, Tengen released their version of *Tetris* on the NES on May 17, 1989, selling tens of thousands of copies within a few weeks.[78] The next month, Judge Fern M. Smith of the US District Court for the Northern District of California presided over competing lawsuits from Atari Games and Nintendo over their console rights to *Tetris*.[79] Both companies motioned for preliminary injunctions that would prohibit the other company from selling *Tetris*. On June 15, 1989, in defense of its motion for injunction, Atari Games argued that the NES fell under the definition of computers under the original contract and that Elorg only excluded consoles from its definition of computers to take advantage of higher profits from Nintendo. Based on contradicting evidence, Smith rejected this argument and declared that Mirrorsoft and Spectrum HoloByte had never received explicit authorization for marketing on consoles, granting a preliminary injunction against Atari Games on June 22.[79]

The next day, Atari Games withdrew its NES version from sale, and thousands of cartridges remained unsold in its warehouses. Preference for this release over Nintendo's led to Atari Games cartridges selling for up to $300 on the secondary market.[80] The Game Boy version of *Tetris* was released in Japan on June 14, 1989,[81] and as a pack-in game in the United States on July 31, 1989.[82][83] Nintendo's NES version was released the same year. Both releases achieved commercial success.[84] *Tetris* was the primary game promoted for the Game Boy, becoming its killer app.[85] It generated $80 million in revenue[86] and popularized both the Game Boy and *Tetris*.[87][88] The NES version quickly sold three million copies and appeared on Nintendo's most popular games list for over a year.[83][89]

On November 13, 1989, Smith ended the legal battle between Nintendo and Atari Games regarding *Tetris* by summary judgment, granting Nintendo the console rights to *Tetris*.[90] In 1991, with Rogers' help, Pajitnov and his family emigrated to Seattle, where he worked as a freelance game designer.[91][92] During this time, Pajitnov worked on several sequels to *Tetris*. *Welltris* (1990) involved adjusting geometrical pieces descending down one of four walls of a three-dimensional well, and *Hatris* (1990) and *Faces...tris III* (1991) replaced descending tetrominoes with hats and faces respectively.[93] Though they generally received positive reviews and commercial success,[92] with *Faces...Tris III* winning "Best Action/Arcade Program" in the 1991 Excellence in Software Awards,[94] none replicated *Tetris*' success.[95][96] Other early versions and sequels of *Tetris* were developed without Pajitnov's involvement, including Spectrum Holobyte's *Super Tetris* (1991), Bullet-Proof Software's *Tetris 2 + BomBliss* (1991) and *Tetris Battle Gaiden* (1993), and Nintendo's *Tetris 2* (1993).[93]

The Tetris Company and Blue Planet Software (1995–2012)



A fifth-generation iPod running *Tetris* (2006)

The Dorodnitsyn Computing Center's rights to *Tetris* expired at the end of 1995, reverting back to Pajitnov.[32] Worried that Elorg, which had become a private company under Belikov during the 1991 collapse of the Soviet Union,[91] would try to claim the rights, Pajitnov recruited Rogers to secure them. Rogers formed Blue Planet Software and, after a year of negotiations, established the Tetris Company as an equal partnership between Elorg and Blue Planet Software in 1996,[97] "to own and administer" the *Tetris* rights,[91] and "to serve as the exclusive source of all Tetris licenses".[98] Blue Planet Software served as the "exclusive agent for the *Tetris* brand".[93]:25 In 1996, the Tetris Company created quality and consistency guidelines for *Tetris* games and a "minimum specification" that licensed games must follow.[93]:25 Rogers acquired Elorg in 2005 and then formed a new company, Tetris Holding, to which the *Tetris* trademarks and rights were transferred.[98][97] The Tetris Company has also enforced its copyright of *Tetris* against unauthorized clones,[99][100] such as in the 2012 case *Tetris Holding, LLC v. Xio Interactive, Inc.*, where a judge ruled that the iOS game *Mino* violated *Tetris*'s copyright based on look and feel.[101]

Pajitnov and Rogers sought to keep *Tetris* versions fresh, and innovated in new directions. *Tetrisphere*, developed by H2O Entertainment and released on August 11, 1997, was an example of this innovation.[93][102] Gameplay involved rotating a three-dimensional sphere to place pieces on its surface. It was the first puzzle video game on the Nintendo 64 and garnered a cult following.[103][104] David Crookes of *Retro Gamer* called *Tetrisphere* "proof that the concept could be modernised and tweaked, while still being faithful to the original".[93] Another version on the Nintendo 64, the Japan-exclusive *Tetris 64* (1998), allowed for four players and was the only game to use the Nintendo 64's Bio Sensor, which detects the player's pulse.[93][105] On other platforms around this time, *Tetris Plus* (1996), *Tetris DX* (1998), and *The Next Tetris* (1999) added new game modes, and *Tetris: The Grand Master* (1998) was an arcade game aimed at experienced players.[93]

According to Rogers, in order to appeal to beginner players, the Tetris Company started to incorporate features not in the original releases into the *Tetris* guidelines.[106] These features included the hold feature and ability to perform both soft drops and hard drops in *The New Tetris* in 1999,[107] the easy spin and super rotation system in *Tetris Worlds* in 2001,[108] and the scoring system introduced in *Tetris DS* in 2006.[5] Critics panned *Tetris Worlds* for the easy spin mechanic, which allowed players to delay a piece's descent by continually rotating it. Despite the controversy and Pajitnov's reluctance, the mechanic was implemented into the *Tetris* guidelines.[109][106] *Tetris Worlds* also introduced the super rotation system, defining how pieces are to rotate,[108] which most *Tetris* games have since used.[5]

Tetris was first released on mobile devices in 2001 by G-Mode.[110] In 2002, Rogers formed Blue Lava Wireless to develop *Tetris* games for mobile platforms.[93] JAMDAT acquired Blue Lava Wireless in April 2005, granting the former a 15-year license of *Tetris* for mobile platforms.[111] By December 2005, when Electronic Arts (EA) started its acquisition of JAMDAT, *Tetris* had been consistently selling well on American carrier phones.[112] EA completed its acquisition in February 2006, granting it the mobile license for *Tetris*.[113] EA Mobile released their mobile version of *Tetris* as a launch game for the iTunes

store on iPod 5G on September 11, 2006,[114][115] and on the Apple App Store on iOS on July 10, 2008.[116] By January 2010, EA's mobile releases reached 100 million paid downloads, making *Tetris* the most popular mobile game at the time.[117]

Maya Rogers' succession and resurgence of popularity (2014–present)



Maya Rogers (pictured in 2022) succeeded her father as CEO of Blue Planet Software in January 2014.

In January 2014, after eight years of involvement, Henk Rogers' daughter Maya succeeded him as the CEO of Blue Planet Software.[e] She began by planning activities for *Tetris*'s 30th anniversary. In an interview with *VentureBeat* in June 2014, Maya spoke of her desire to expand *Tetris*'s brand, such as through merchandising, and keeping the game fresh.[120] Sega released *Puyo Puyo Tetris*, a crossover between *Tetris* and *Puyo Puyo*, in Japan on February 6, 2014, for multiple platforms.[121] *Puyo Puyo Tetris* sold over 60,000 copies within a week, with the Nintendo 3DS port being the second-highest-selling game of the week according to *4Gamer.net*.[122] Ubisoft's *Tetris Ultimate* was released on the Nintendo 3DS in November 2014 and the PlayStation 4 and Xbox One in December 2014.[123] *Tetris Ultimate* received mixed reviews, though the online multiplayer was generally seen favorably.[124][93]

In the late 2010s, the *Tetris* series had a resurgence in popularity with the release of *Tetris Effect* and *Tetris 99*.[f] *PCMag* credited the resurgence to the 2017 release of *Puyo Puyo Tetris* in the Western world,[126] where it received positive reviews and sold 1.4 million copies worldwide by November 2020.[131][132] *Tetris Effect*, developed by Monstars and Resonair and published by Enhance Games,[133] was released on the PlayStation 4 on November 9, 2018,[134] and on Windows on July 23, 2019,[135] receiving widespread critical acclaim for its visuals and emotional impact.[125][136][137] *Tetris 99* is a battle royale version of *Tetris* made available to subscribers of Nintendo Switch Online on February 13, 2019, upon its surprise announcement during Nintendo Direct.[138] It received positive reviews and became Nintendo Switch Online's killer app;[125][126][139] according to President of Nintendo Shuntaro Furukawa, 2.8 million Nintendo Switch Online users played *Tetris 99* within a few months of release.[140]

EA announced in January 2020 that its license for mobile releases of *Tetris* would expire on April 21, 2020, with the game becoming inoperable as a result.[141] Video game developer N3twork subsequently released authorized mobile releases on the iOS and Android on January 23, 2020.[142] These accumulated 30 million downloads before social casino company PlayStudios acquired the rights to them in November 2021.[143] On March 28, 2023, Playstudios incorporated a playAwards loyalty program onto the *Tetris* mobile apps, allowing players to win points for playing *Tetris* that can be redeemed for real-life awards.[144] *Tetris Forever*, a compilation of *Tetris* games and interactive documentary developed by Digital Eclipse, was released on November 12, 2024,[145] to positive reviews for chronicling the history of *Tetris*.[146][147]

Versions

Tetris has been released on multiple platforms, including game consoles, personal computers, and smartphones. Pajitnov said there are hundreds of versions of *Tetris*.[148] *Guinness World Records* recognizes *Tetris* as the most ported video game, having appeared on at least 70 platforms,[149] and as the video game with the most distinct versions (approximately 220 official), each featuring unique elements such as music and images.[150]

The core gameplay has remained consistent.[1] Since 1996, the Tetris Company has maintained annual standard specifications for authorized versions of *Tetris*.[21][106] Pajitnov considers these guidelines a baseline for different versions and not "set in stone".[151] Several game mechanics of *Tetris* have been changed over time. For example, the distribution of tetrominoes was completely randomized in early versions, while modern versions use a "bag system", in which each tetromino is guaranteed to appear once in a set of seven.[152][153] Other mechanics that have become standardized in modern versions include the ability to hold tetrominoes to swap with later pieces, introduced in *The New Tetris* (1999),[154] and the super rotation system and infinite spin, introduced in *Tetris Worlds* (2001).[108]

The original Elektronika 60 version of *Tetris* had no music.[155] Spectrum Holobyte's version of *Tetris* in the United States exoticized the Soviet origins through elements such as Russian music, including Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky's "Trepak" from *The Nutcracker* and Reinhold Glière's "Russian Sailor Dance" from *The Red Poppy*. This approach differed from other versions of *Tetris* from other countries at the time: Mirrorsoft's Commodore 64 versions in Europe used an atmospheric soundtrack, and Sega's arcade version in Japan used a synthesized pop-influenced soundtrack.[156] Nintendo's versions for NES and Game Boy continued the pattern of using Russian music. The NES version uses Tchaikovsky's "Dance of the Sugar Plum Fairy" from *The Nutcracker* as Music A, with the Russian-influenced Music B and the mellow Music C having unclear origins.[157] The Game Boy version has the 1860s Russian folk tune "Korobeiniki" for Music A, an original composition by Hirokazu Tanaka for Music B, and the Menuet of Johann Sebastian Bach's *French Suite no. 3* for Music C.[158] "Korobeiniki" has become primarily associated with *Tetris* as its main theme and would be used in most significant versions within the series,[159][156] as mandated by the Tetris Company guidelines.[21]

Reception

Sales

In January 2010, EA Mobile and Blue Planet Software announced that the mobile versions of *Tetris* released 2005 had reached 100 million paid downloads, making it the most-downloaded mobile game at the time.[170][117] In April 2014, Rogers announced in an interview with *VentureBeat* that *Tetris* totaled 425 million paid mobile downloads and 70 million physical copies, making it the best-selling video game of all time.[171][172] According to the Tetris Company, *Tetris* had sold 520 million copies as of December 2024.[161] *Tetris* is also the second-best-selling video game series.[173][174] The majority of the sales originate from paid mobile downloads, based on Rogers' figure from the 2014 interview.[172][175] Some sources, like the BBC, dispute the claim of *Tetris* being the best-selling video game due to differences between the versions, including on mobile platforms.[173] The most commercially successful version is the Game Boy version,[176] which at 35 million copies is among the best-selling video games.[161][177]

Accolades

Sales of selected versions of *Tetris*

Year	Game	Platform(s)	Sales
1988	*Tetris* (Spectrum HoloByte)	PC	1 million[160]
	Tetris (Famicom)	Famicom	2 million[60]
1989	*Tetris* (Game Boy)	Game Boy	35 million[161]
	Tetris (NES)	NES	8 million[162]
1996	*Tetris Plus*	PlayStation	1.53 million[163]
1997	*Tetrisphere*	Nintendo 64	430,000[164]
2001	*Tetris Worlds*	Multi-platform	1.81 million[g]
2006	*Tetris DS*	Nintendo DS	2.05 million[167]
2014	*Puyo Puyo Tetris*	Multi-platform	1.4 million[132]
2020	*Puyo Puyo Tetris 2*	Multi-platform	293,000[h]

Tetris has garnered accolades and awards since its initial commercial release. The Spectrum HoloByte version won three Software Publishers Association Excellence in Software awards in 1989, including Best Entertainment Program and the Critic's Choice Award for consumers.[50] *Macworld* inducted *Tetris* into the 1988 *Macworld* Game Hall of Fame in the Best Strategy Game category. *Macworld* praised "the addictive quality" and said its "simplicity is bewitching",[178] and *Compute!* gave *Tetris* the 1989 Choice Award for Arcade Game, describing it as "by far, the most addictive game ever".[179] *Entertainment Weekly* named the NES version the eighth-greatest game available for sale in 1991, saying: "Thanks to Nintendo's endless promotion, *Tetris* has become one of the most popular video games."[180]

Tetris is considered among the greatest video games,[181] being ranked as such by *Flux* (1995),[182] *Next Generation* (1996 and 1999),[183][184] *Electronic Gaming Monthly* (1997),[185] *GameSpot* (2000),[186] *Game Informer* (2001 and 2009),[187][188] *IGN* (2007 and 2021),[189][190] *Time* (2012 and 2016),[191][192] *GamesRadar+* (2015 and 2021),[193][194] *Polygon* (2017),[195] *USA Today* (2022 and 2024),[196][197] *The Times* (2023),[198] and *GQ* (2023).[199] *Tetris* has also been ranked as among the best computer games by *PC Format* (1991)[200] and *Computer Gaming World* (1996),[201] among the best video game franchises by *IGN* (2006)[202] and *Den of Geek* (2024),[203] and among the most influential games by *GamePro* (2007),[204] *IGN* (2007),[205] *1Up.com* (2010),[206] *GamesRadar+* (2013),[207] and *The Guardian* (2017).[208]

Tetris has been inducted into the "Hall of Fame" of the following publications: *Computer Gaming World* (1999),[209] *GameSpy* (2000),[210] *GameSpot* (2003),[211] and *IGN* (2007).[212] At the 2007 Game Developers Choice Awards, Pajitnov won the First Penguin Award, known afterward as the Pioneer Award, for pioneering casual gaming through *Tetris*.[213][214] *Tetris* was listed as part of the game canon, announced at the 2007 Game Developers Conference by Henry Lowood of Stanford University as a list of ten games to be considered for preservation by the Library of Congress, modeled after the National Film Preservation Board.[215][216] In November 2012, the Museum of Modern Art acquired *Tetris*, along with thirteen other video games, to display.[217] As part of the 2015 inaugural class, The Strong National Museum of Play inducted *Tetris* into the World Video Game Hall of Fame for its iconic nature.[218]

Legacy

Industry impact

Due to Rogers and Nintendo's belief in its potential for mass appeal, *Tetris* was the pack-in game and the primary game promoted for the Game Boy in the United States. The resulting public anticipation led *Tetris* to become the Game Boy's main draw,[85][219][220] with many, including non-gamers, buying the Game Boy specifically to play *Tetris*. It contributed to both the popularity of *Tetris* and the Game Boy,[221][88][222] with the bundle selling out its initial run of a million copies shortly after release.[85] This success established Nintendo's dominant position in the handheld gaming market, setting a standard that competitors struggled to replicate.[206][223][224] Several writers credit *Tetris* and *Pokémon Red and Blue* (1996) for the Game Boy's longevity, as it would not be discontinued until 2003.[222][85][225]

Tetris is influential in the genre of puzzle video games.[205][226] Commentators have considered *Tetris* an early example of a casual game.[i] *Wired* deemed *Tetris* unique for its time, given its appeal to players regardless of gender and age,[228] and *1Up.com* credits *Tetris* for establishing a market for puzzle video games with universal appeal.[206] Various common elements of puzzle games, such as managing pieces over a fixed screen, originated from *Tetris*,[205] and multiple clones have been created to replicate *Tetris*'s popularity.[231] Video games influenced by *Tetris* include Nintendo's *Dr. Mario* (1990), Sega's *Columns* (1990), Compile's *Puyo Puyo* (1991), Taito's *Puzzle Bobble* (1994), and Capcom's *Super Puzzle Fighter II Turbo* (1996).[j]

Cultural impact

Tetris's cultural impact and recognition is widespread, being represented in a vast array of video game platforms, among other media such as architecture, art, and merchandise.[233][21][93] *Tetris* has been frequently referenced in pop culture, such as in *The Simpsons*, *The Big Bang Theory*,[93] *Family Guy*, *Futurama*, *Office Space*,[234] *Muppet Babies*, and Monty Python.[235] The game has also earned multiple Guinness records, such as the record for "largest architectural video game display", granted to a game of *Tetris* hosted on the side of the 29-story Cira Center in April 2014.[236] "Korobeiniki", a Russian folk song, has become widely associated with *Tetris* following its inclusion in the Game Boy version.[156] A 1992 Eurodance cover of "Korobeiniki" by Doctor Spin peaked at number six on the UK singles charts.[21][237] The "*Tetris* effect" refers to the phenomena of perceiving certain patterns in dreams and mental images following engagement in a repetitive activity such as playing *Tetris*.[238][239] The term was coined by Jeffrey Goldsmith in a 1994 article for *Wired*,[240] in which he compared *Tetris* to an "electronic drug".[241]



Jonas Neubauer (pictured in 2010) won the inaugural Classic Tetris World Championship.

The background of *Tetris*, including its creation and legal battles in the late 1980s, has been documented multiple times.[242] David Sheff provided a comprehensive overview in his influential Nintendo history book *Game Over* (1994). Subsequent books that covered this topic include the non-fiction books Steven

L. Kent's *The Ultimate History of Video Games* (2001), Tristan Donovan's *Replay: The History of Video Games* (2010), Dan Ackerman's *The Tetris Effect* (2016), and the graphic novel Box Brown's *Tetris: The Games People Play* (2016).[243][242] *Tetris* has also been the subject of documentaries including BBC's *Tetris: From Russia with Love* (2004) and the independent *Ecstasy of Order: The Tetris Masters* (2010).[243][242] *Tetris*, a film dramatization of the legal battles starring Taron Egerton as Rogers, premiered on Apple TV+ on March 31, 2023,[239] to positive reviews, according to Metacritic, and a viewership of 88,000 people, according to Samba TV.[244][245] Henk Rogers' memoir, *The Perfect Game —Tetris: From Russia With Love*, was published on April 1, 2025, to provide his perspective on *Tetris*'s history following the film's release.[246][247]

Tetris is part of the competitive gaming scene, especially around the NES version.[248] Competitor Jonas Neubauer and his victory in the inaugural Classic Tetris World Championship (CTWC) in 2010 were the subjects of *Ecstasy of Order: The Tetris Masters*,[249] which helped popularized competitive gameplay of *Tetris*.[227] Competitors at the CTWC, typically adolescents, have used the CTWC to demonstrate advancements in the gameplay of the NES version. For example, gameplay techniques such as "hypertapping" and "rolling" have been used to help competitors to maximize their scores beyond level 29, which was previously deemed impossible to complete due to its speed.[250][251] Willis Gibson "beat" Tetris by playing NES *Tetris* until it crashed in a 40-minute livestream in January 2024, receiving significant media coverage for his achievement.[252][253]

Research

The *Tetris* game has frequently been featured in academic research, including in psychology, computer science, and game studies.[3] By 2014, John K. Lindstedt and Wayne D. Gray, cognitive scientists of the Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, had traced 133 scholarly papers across a variety of academic fields that used *Tetris* in their research.[254] Soviet clinical psychologist Vladimir Pokhilko was the first to use *Tetris* in clinical experiments, conducting them around 1985 at the Moscow Medical Center.[238][3] Prior to studying them, Pokhilko observed that distributed copies of *Tetris* to his colleagues impaired medical research due to their constant gameplay. Although he initially destroyed these copies, after new copies were reintroduced to his facility, Pokhilko used *Tetris* in psychological tests of his patients.[255]

In psychology, starting with the research of American psychologist Richard J. Haier in 1992,[256][257][258] *Tetris* has been frequently used in neuroimaging studies testing how gameplay affects the human brain.[259][254] For example, the near-transfer effects of *Tetris* on mental rotation is frequently researched, though research methods have varied widely and results have been contradictory.[260] Furthermore, *Tetris* has been studied as a potential form of psychological intervention, particularly regarding post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD).[259] To date, playing *Tetris* as a valid form of imagery treatment for symptoms of PTSD is in an experimental stage and in need of further research. Nonetheless, several systematic reviews and meta-analyses of studies have demonstrated some evidence supporting its effectiveness in reducing intrusive memories, especially when combined with other interventions.[261][262][263]

In computer science, the *Tetris* game has been the subject of research papers analyzing how the tetrominoes affect gameplay.[264] Most analyze a traditional game of *Tetris* and do not account for features such as queue.[265] In 1992, John Brzustowski argued in his master's thesis for the University of Waterloo that it is impossible to play a traditional game of *Tetris* indefinitely,[266][267] a conclusion affirmed by Heidi Burgiel of the University of Minnesota in 1997, who attributed the inevitable end to the game's Z-shaped tetrominoes and calculated a hard cap of seventy thousand tetrominoes.[268][269] Partly

accounting for the queue feature, in 2003 a trio of MIT students proved that the optimal strategy for playing a game of *Tetris* is NP-complete, meaning it is difficult to be solved by an algorithm within a reasonable time due to the game's complexity. This is true even if the player knew the complete sequence of incoming pieces.[270][271][272]

See also



- *Brain Wall* and *Blokken*, game shows based on *Tetris*

Notes

a. The date shown corresponds to the first commercial release, while earlier versions of *Tetris* had been circulating starting c. 1985.

b. Pronounced ['tʲetrʲɪs] or ['tetrʲɪs]

c. Some sources consider *Minecraft* to be the best-selling video game, rejecting the aggregated sales of *Tetris* and considering it to be a series, rather than a single video game; see List of best-selling video games for more information.

d. The standard spelling in mathematics is *tetrominoes*, while the Tetris Company's trademarked spelling is *tetriminoes*.[2] This article uses the standard spelling for consistency.

e. An October 2020 press release announced that Blue Planet Software was renamed to Tetris.[118] To date, Henk is officially the president of the Tetris Company, while Maya is the president and CEO of Tetris, Inc.[119]

f. Attributed to multiple sources:[125][126][127][128][129][130]

g. *Tetris Worlds* sold 960,000 copies for Game Boy Advance[165] and 850,000 for PlayStation 2.[166]

h. *Puyo Puyo Tetris 2* sold 93,000 copies.[168] *Puyo Puyo Tetris 2: Special Price* sold 200,000 copies.[169]

i. Attributed to multiple sources:[205][227][228][229][230]

j. Attributed to multiple sources:[205][206][226][232]

References

1. Plank 2022, p. 268.
2. Plank 2022, p. 271.

3. Wolf, Mark J. P. (August 31, 2012). "*Tetris*" (https://archive.org/details/isbn_9780313379369_2/page/640/mode/2up). *Encyclopedia of Video Games: The Culture, Technology, and Art of Gaming*. Santa Barbara, CA: Greenwood Press. pp. 640–642. ISBN 978-0-313-37936-9 – via Internet Archive.
4. Salen, Katie; Zimmerman, Eric (2003). *Rules of Play: Game Design Fundamentals* (https://archive.org/details/rulesofplaygamed0000sale/page/143/mode/2up). Cambridge: MIT Press. pp. 143–144. ISBN 978-0-262-24045-1 – via Internet Archive.
5. Ramos, Jeff (February 22, 2019). "*Tetris* Tips from a Seven-Time World Champion" (https://www.polygon.com/guides/2019/2/22/18225349/tetris-strategy-tips-how-to-jonas-neubauer). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250114154632/https://www.polygon.com/guides/2019/2/22/18225349/tetris-strategy-tips-how-to-jonas-neubauer) from the original on January 14, 2025. Retrieved February 6, 2025.
6. Ramos, Jeff (March 6, 2019). "*Tetris* Advanced Guide: T-spins, Perfect Clears, and Combos" (https://www.polygon.com/guides/2019/3/6/18244590/tetris-t-spin-perfect-clear-combo-guide). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190306212036/https://www.polygon.com/guides/2019/3/6/18244590/tetris-t-spin-perfect-clear-combo-guide) from the original on March 6, 2019. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
7. Ackerman 2016, pp. 30–31.
8. テトリスを創った男 パジトノフ独占インタビュー [Exclusive interview with Pajitnov, the man who created Tetris]. *The Super Famicom* (in Japanese). Vol. 4, no. 7. SoftBank. April 16, 1993. pp. 72–73.
9. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 298.
10. Kent 2001, p. 377.
11. Hoad, Phil (June 2, 2014). "*Tetris*: How We Made the Addictive Computer Game" (https://www.theguardian.com/culture/2014/jun/02/how-we-made-tetris). *The Guardian*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20170621140034/https://www.theguardian.com/culture/2014/jun/02/how-we-made-tetris) from the original on June 21, 2017. Retrieved July 5, 2014.
12. Ackerman 2016, p. 32.
13. Temple 2004, 03:12–04:42.
14. Pajitnov & Rogers 2023, 1:50.
15. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 299.
16. Ackerman 2016, pp. 33–34.
17. Donovan 2010, p. 200.
18. Loguidice & Barton 2009, p. 293.
19. Pajitnov & Rogers 2023, 1:20.
20. McFerran, Damien; Yarwood, Jack (June 24, 2024). "Anniversary: Is *Tetris* Really 40 This Year?" (https://web.archive.org/web/20240717140506/https://www.timeextension.com/news/2024/06/anniversary-is-tetris-really-40-this-year). *Time Extension*. Archived from the original (https://www.timeextension.com/news/2024/06/anniversary-is-tetris-really-40-this-year) on July 17, 2024. Retrieved November 18, 2024.
21. Johnson, Bobbie (June 1, 2009). "How *Tetris* Conquered the World, Block by Block" (https://www.theguardian.com/technology/gamesblog/2009/jun/02/tetris-25anniversary-alexey-pajitnov). *The Guardian*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20150329135242/http://www.theguardian.com/technology/gamesblog/2009/jun/02/tetris-25anniversary-alexey-pajitnov) from the original on March 29, 2015. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
22. Temple 2004, 6:32–7:02.
23. Ackerman 2016, pp. 35–36.
24. Ackerman 2016, pp. 62.
25. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 300.
26. Ackerman 2016, pp. 54–56.

27. Ackerman 2016, pp. 63–65.
28. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 300–301.
29. Ackerman 2016, p. 70.
30. Ackerman 2016, p. 89.
31. "Интеллектуальная собственность / Тетрис" (https://web.archive.org/web/20140304100515/https://www.kommersant.ru/doc/11471) [Intellectual Property / *Tetris*]. *Kommersant* (in Russian). September 12, 1995. Archived from the original (https://www.kommersant.ru/doc/11471) on March 4, 2014. Retrieved November 30, 2024.
32. Prisco, Jacopo (October 31, 2019). "*Tetris*: The Soviet 'Mind Game' that Took Over the World" (https://www.cnn.com/style/article/tetris-video-game-history/index.html). *CNN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20191101023959/https://www.cnn.com/style/article/tetris-video-game-history/index.html) from the original on November 1, 2019. Retrieved February 6, 2025.
33. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 301.
34. Ackerman 2016, p. 90.
35. Donovan 2010, pp. 203–204.
36. "Magyar Tetris Commodore 64-en" (https://prohardver.hu/teszt/magyar_tetris_commodore_64-en/a_szaz_kozott.html). *Prohardver.hu* (in Hungarian). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20260308141512/https://prohardver.hu/teszt/magyar_tetris_commodore_64-en/a_szaz_kozott.html%3F_tc%3D1) from the original on March 8, 2026. Retrieved March 8, 2026.
37. Ackerman 2016, pp. 95–97.
38. Ackerman 2016, pp. 97–99.
39. Ackerman 2016, pp. 103–107.
40. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 304–305.
41. Ackerman 2016, pp. 118–119.
42. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 305–306.
43. "Soviets Play Capitalist Game with New Computer Puzzle" (https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1988-01-28-fi-39274-story.html). *The Los Angeles Times*. Reuters. January 28, 1988. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241217174932/https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1988-01-28-fi-39274-story.html) from the original on December 17, 2024. Retrieved November 17, 2024.
44. Lewis, Peter H. (January 29, 1988). "New Software Game: It Comes from Soviet" (https://www.nytimes.com/1988/01/29/business/new-software-game-it-comes-from-soviet.html). *The New York Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20211023171204/https://www.nytimes.com/1988/01/29/business/new-software-game-it-comes-from-soviet.html) from the original on October 23, 2021. Retrieved November 17, 2024.
45. "Magyar Tetris Commodore 64-en" (https://prohardver.hu/teszt/magyar_tetris_commodore_64-en/apatok_jatekot_csinalt.html). *Prohardver.hu* (in Hungarian). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20260308141815/https://prohardver.hu/teszt/magyar_tetris_commodore_64-en/apatok_jatekot_csinalt.html%3F_tc%3D1) from the original on March 8, 2026. Retrieved March 8, 2026.
46. Ackerman 2016, p. 126.
47. Ackerman 2016, p. 124.
48. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 307–308.
49. Donovan 2010, p. 204.
50. Scisco, Peter (August 1989). "The Envelope, Please" (https://archive.org/stream/1989-08-compute-magazine/Compute_Issue_111_1989_Aug#page/n7/mode/2up). *Compute!*. p. 6. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20140316211940/https://archive.org/stream/1989-08-compute-magazine/Compute_Issue_111_1989_Aug#page/n7/mode/2up) from the original on March 16, 2014. Retrieved November 11, 2013.

51. Ackerman 2016, pp. 130–131.
52. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 308.
53. Ackerman 2016, pp. 132–133.
54. Kent 2001, pp. 378–379.
55. Ackerman 2016, pp. 138–142.
56. Ackerman 2016, pp. 143–145.
57. Ackerman 2016, pp. 163–165.
58. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 310–312.
59. Kaneko, Yoichi, ed. (May 20, 1990). *パソコンゲーム80年代記* (https://archive.org/details/pcgame80/page/n93/mode/1up) [*PC Games 1980s Chronicles*] (in Japanese). Tatsumi Publishing. pp. 6, 88.
60. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 312.
61. Ackerman 2016, p. 166.
62. Temple 2004, 22:09–23:03.
63. Ackerman 2016, pp. 167–169.
64. Ackerman 2016, pp. 173–175.
65. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 313.
66. Ackerman 2016, pp. 181–184.
67. Ackerman 2016, pp. 185–187.
68. Donovan 2010, pp. 206–207.
69. Ackerman 2016, pp. 189–190.
70. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 318–320.
71. Ackerman 2016, pp. 208–210, 215.
72. Ackerman 2016, p. 220.
73. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 330–331.
74. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 331–333.
75. Sheff & Eddy 1999, pp. 333–334.
76. Ackerman 2016, pp. 220–221.
77. Ackerman 2016, p. 219.
78. Ackerman 2016, p. 223.
79. Ackerman 2016, p. 224.
80. "From Russia with Litigation" (https://archive.org/details/nextgen-issue-26/page/n43/mode/2up). *Next Generation*. No. 26. February 1997. p. 42 – via Internet Archive.
81. ゲームボーイ (https://www.nintendo.co.jp/n02/dmg/index.html) [Game Boy]. *Nintendo* (in Japanese). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20150317065341/http://www.nintendo.co.jp/n02/dmg/index.html) from the original on March 17, 2015. Retrieved March 29, 2015.
82. Fahs, Travis (July 27, 2009). "*IGN* Presents the History of Game Boy" (https://www.ign.com/articles/2009/07/27/ign-presents-the-history-of-game-boy). *IGN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20100528083411/http://retro.ign.com/articles/100/1007864p3.html) from the original on May 28, 2010. Retrieved November 19, 2024.
83. Ackerman 2016, p. 226.
84. Kent 2001, pp. 379–380.
85. Moss, Richard (April 19, 2019). "How Nintendo Introduced the Game Boy, *Tetris*, and *Pokémon* to the West" (https://www.polygon.com/2019/4/19/18295061/game-boy-history-timeline-tetris-pokemon-nintendo). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190419200933/https://www.polygon.com/2019/4/19/18295061/game-boy-history-timeline-tetris-pokemon-nintendo) from the original on April 19, 2019. Retrieved December 3, 2024.

86. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 343.
87. Ackerman 2016, pp. 226–227.
88. Linneman 2018, 10:58–11:06.
89. Sheff & Eddy 1999, p. 339.
90. Ackerman 2016, p. 227.
91. Ackerman 2016, p. 241.
92. Givens, Ron (May 3, 1991). "Soviet Blocks Invade America" (https://archive.org/details/sim_entertainment-weekly_1991-05-03_64/page/12/mode/2up). *Entertainment Weekly*. No. 64 – via Internet Archive.
93. Crookes, David (September 2018). "The History of *Tetris*". *Retro Gamer*. No. 183. Future Publishing. pp. 20–29.
94. "Celebrating Software" (https://archive.org/details/Computer_Gaming_World_Issue_83/page/n65/). *Computer Gaming World*. No. 83. June 1991. p. 66 – via Internet Archive.
95. Wlsosoczyn, Susan (May 9, 1996). "*Tetris* Inventor Gets a Turn at the Profit Game" (https://www.newspapers.com/article/usa-today-tetris-inventor-gets-a-turn-at/164431581/). *USA Today* – via Newspapers.com.
96. Byrd, Matthew (March 31, 2023). "Why *Tetris*' Creator Never Made *Tetris 2*" (https://www.denofgeek.com/games/why-tetris-creator-never-made-tetris-2/). *Den of Geek*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230331184224/https://www.denofgeek.com/games/why-tetris-creator-never-made-tetris-2/) from the original on March 31, 2023. Retrieved February 4, 2025.
97. Rogers, Henk (September 9, 2009). "The Man Who Won *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20210830150307/https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/the-man-who-won-tetris). *Game Developer* (Interview). Archived from the original (https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/the-man-who-won-tetris) on August 30, 2021. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
98. Rogers, Henk (June 6, 2014). "Tetris at 30: An Interview with the Historic Puzzle Game's Creator" (https://web.archive.org/web/20140606141137/https://time.com/2837390/tetris-at-30-pajitnov-interview/). *Time* (Interview). Interviewed by Matt Peckham. Archived from the original (https://time.com/2837390/tetris-at-30-pajitnov-interview/) on June 6, 2014. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
99. Chartier, David (October 8, 2008). "Tetris Co. Strikes Again: Another iPhone App Clone is Pulled" (https://arstechnica.com/gadgets/2008/10/tetris-co-strikes-again-another-iphone-app-clone-is-pulled/). *Ars Technica*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20200808232640/https://arstechnica.com/gadgets/2008/10/tetris-co-strikes-again-another-iphone-app-clone-is-pulled/) from the original on August 8, 2020. Retrieved April 9, 2020.
100. Ryan, Paul (June 2, 2010). "Google Blocks *Tetris* Clones from Android Market" (https://arstechnica.com/gadgets/2010/06/google-blocks-tetris-clones-from-android-market/). *Ars Technica*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20121202210616/http://arstechnica.com/gadgets/2010/06/google-blocks-tetris-clones-from-android-market/) from the original on December 2, 2012. Retrieved June 23, 2012.
101. Brown, Mark (June 21, 2012). "Judge Declares iOS Tetris Clone 'Infringing' " (https://www.wired.com/2012/06/wireduk-tetris-clone/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20171019163633/https://www.wired.com/2012/06/wireduk-tetris-clone/) from the original on October 19, 2017. Retrieved January 19, 2021.
102. Lee, Helen (July 2, 1997). "*Tetrisphere* Gets Rolling" (https://web.archive.org/web/19990504104718/http://headline.gamespot.com/news/97_07/02_tetris/index.html). *GameSpot*. Archived from the original (http://headline.gamespot.com/news/97_07/02_tetris/index.html) on May 4, 1999. Retrieved February 8, 2025.
103. Thomas, Lucas M. (September 21, 2010). "The 3DS's N64 Encores" (https://web.archive.org/web/20250831072220/https://www.ign.com/articles/2010/09/22/the-3dss-n64-encores). *IGN*. Archived from the original (https://www.ign.com/articles/2010/09/22/the-3dss-n64-encores) on August 31, 2025. Retrieved February 10, 2025.

104. Scullion, Chris (October 12, 2016). "The *Tetris* Games No One Remembers" (https://www.redbull.com/gb-en/tetris-game-spin-offs). *Red Bull Games*. Retrieved February 10, 2025.
105. Kohler, Chris (June 8, 2009). "Nintendo 'Vitality Sensor' Already Appeared on N64" (https://www.wired.com/2009/06/nintendo-vitality-sensor/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240324012445/https://www.wired.com/2009/06/nintendo-vitality-sensor/) from the original on March 24, 2024. Retrieved February 10, 2025.
106. Rogers, Henk (April 6, 2006). "*Tetris* from the Top: An Interview with Henk Rogers" (http://www.nintendoworldreport.com/interview/11267/tetris-from-the-top-an-interview-with-henk-rogers). *Nintendo World Report*. Interviewed by Jonathan Mett. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20140311043518/http://www.nintendoworldreport.com/interview/11267/tetris-from-the-top-an-interview-with-henk-rogers) from the original on March 11, 2014. Retrieved April 28, 2007.
107. Linneman 2018, 31:11–31:34.
108. Linneman 2018, 37:42–38:07.
109. Grannel, Craig (2021). "Queasy Spin" (https://archive.org/details/retro-gamer-100-playstation-games-to-play-before-you-die-3nd-edition/page/78/mode/2up). *Retro Gamer*. p. 78 – via Internet Archive.
110. Stuart, Keith (January 21, 2010). "*Tetris* and *Snake* - The Biggest Games in the World" (https://web.archive.org/web/20250110013147/https://www.theguardian.com/technology/gamesblog/2010/jan/21/games-casual-gaming). *The Guardian*. Archived from the original (https://www.theguardian.com/technology/gamesblog/2010/jan/21/games-casual-gaming) on January 10, 2025. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
111. Gibson, Ellie (April 22, 2005). "Jamdat Acquires Blue Lava Wireless" (https://www.gamesindustry.biz/jamdat-acquires-blue-lava-wireless). *GamesIndustry.biz*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240525145218/https://www.gamesindustry.biz/jamdat-acquires-blue-lava-wireless) from the original on May 25, 2024. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
112. Buchanan, Levi (December 8, 2005). "EA Buys JAMDAT" (https://www.ign.com/articles/2005/12/08/ea-buys-jamdat). *IGN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20161201043628/http://www.ign.com/articles/2005/12/08/ea-buys-jamdat) from the original on December 1, 2016. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
113. Carless, Simon (February 14, 2006). "EA Officially Completes Jamdat Acquisition" (https://www.gamedeveloper.com/game-platforms/ea-officially-completes-jamdat-acquisition). *Game Developer*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240926062612/https://www.gamedeveloper.com/game-platforms/ea-officially-completes-jamdat-acquisition) from the original on September 26, 2024. Retrieved September 25, 2024.
114. Buchanan, Levi (September 15, 2006). "iPod Game Review Central" (https://www.ign.com/articles/2006/09/16/ipod-game-review-central). *IGN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240923064816/https://www.ign.com/articles/2006/09/16/ipod-game-review-central) from the original on September 23, 2024. Retrieved September 23, 2024.
115. Cohen, Peter (May 8, 2007). "EA Has Four New iPod Games in the Pipeline" (https://www.macworld.com/article/185577/ea-2.html). *MacWorld*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230610075859/https://www.macworld.com/article/185577/ea-2.html) from the original on June 10, 2023. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
116. Cohen, Peter (July 10, 2008). "EA Announces iPhone Game Lineup" (https://www.macworld.com/article/191429/eagames-2.html). *MacWorld*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230205233221/https://www.macworld.com/article/191429/eagames-2.html) from the original on February 5, 2023. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
117. Meyer, John (January 22, 2010). "With 100M Downloads, *Tetris* is World's Hottest Mobile Game" (https://www.wired.com/2010/01/tetris-100-million-sold/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250121003903/https://www.wired.com/2010/01/tetris-100-million-sold/) from the original on January 21, 2025. Retrieved December 14, 2024.

118. "Call Us Tetris! Blue Planet Software, the Sole Agent for the *Tetris* Brand Gets New Name" (https://tetris.com/article/241/call-us-tetris-blue-planet-software-the-sole-agent-for-the-tetris-brand-gets-new-name). *The Tetris Company* (Press release). October 21, 2020. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230826205845/https://tetris.com/article/241/call-us-tetris-blue-planet-software-the-sole-agent-for-the-tetris-brand-gets-new-name) from the original on August 26, 2023. Retrieved February 4, 2025.
119. "Corporate Bios" (https://tetris.com/bios). *The Tetris Company*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20210314123813/https://tetris.com/bios) from the original on March 14, 2021. Retrieved February 4, 2025.
120. Rogers, Maya (June 20, 2014). "After Three Decades, *Tetris* Becomes a Multigenerational Game" (https://venturebeat.com/games/after-three-decades-tetris-becomes-a-multigenerational-game/view-all/). *VentureBeat* (Interview). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230928064546/https://venturebeat.com/games/after-three-decades-tetris-becomes-a-multigenerational-game/view-all/) from the original on September 28, 2023. Retrieved January 31, 2025.
121. "『ぷよぷよテトリス』ダウンロードコンテンツ配信開始！" (https://web.archive.org/web/20140214180013/https://puyo.sega.jp/topics/2014/0206_02/index.html) [*Puyo Puyo Tetris* Downloadable Content Now Available!]. *Sega* (in Japanese). February 6, 2014. Archived from the original (https://puyo.sega.jp/topics/2014/0206_02/index.html) on February 14, 2014. Retrieved January 31, 2025.
122. "「ドラゴンクエストモンスターズ2 イルとルカの不思議なふしぎな鍵」が初登場44万3000本の「ゲームソフト週間販売ランキング＋」" (https://www.4gamer.net/games/117/G011794/20140212058/) [*Dragon Quest Monsters 2: Iru and Luka's Mysterious Key* Debuts in the "Game Software Weekly Sales Ranking+" with 443,000 Copies Sold]. *4Gamer.net*. February 12, 2014. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241206040547/https://www.4gamer.net/games/117/G011794/20140212058/) from the original on December 6, 2024. Retrieved January 31, 2025.
123. Perez, Daniel (December 12, 2014). "*Tetris Ultimate* Stacks onto PlayStation 4 and Xbox One Next Week" (https://www.shacknews.com/article/87463/tetris-ultimate-stacks-onto-playstation-4-and-xbox-one-next-week). *Shacknews*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20141225044044/http://www.shacknews.com/article/87463/tetris-ultimate-stacks-onto-playstation-4-and-xbox-one-next-week) from the original on December 25, 2014. Retrieved January 31, 2025.
124. "*Tetris Ultimate*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20241216030828/https://www.metacritic.com/game/tetris-ultimate/). *Metacritic*. Archived from the original (https://www.metacritic.com/game/3ds/tetris-ultimate) on December 16, 2024. Retrieved January 31, 2025.
125. Dring, Christopher (May 29, 2019). "How Everything Has Fallen into Place for *Tetris*" (https://www.gamesindustry.biz/the-rise-of-tetris). *GamesIndustry.biz*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241006130012/https://www.gamesindustry.biz/the-rise-of-tetris) from the original on October 6, 2024. Retrieved February 3, 2025.
126. Wilson, Jeffrey L. (February 25, 2019). "The *Tetris* Renaissance: This Console Generation's Most Unexpected Blessing" (https://www.pcmag.com/opinions/the-tetris-renaissance-this-console-generations-most-unexpected-blessing). *PCMag*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250121121400/https://www.pcmag.com/opinions/the-tetris-renaissance-this-console-generations-most-unexpected-blessing) from the original on January 21, 2025. Retrieved February 3, 2025.
127. Singletary, Charles (March 8, 2019). "CTWC Pros Offer Tips for Getting Better at *Tetris 99*" (https://www.shacknews.com/article/110392/ctwc-pros-offer-tips-for-getting-better-at-tetris-99). *Shacknews*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20220818112735/https://www.shacknews.com/article/110392/ctwc-pros-offer-tips-for-getting-better-at-tetris-99) from the original on August 18, 2022. Retrieved February 3, 2025.

128. Miller, Ross (February 13, 2019). "*Tetris* Battle Royale Is Real and Free on Nintendo Switch Today" (https://www.polygon.com/nintendo-switch/2019/2/13/18224042/tetris-99-nintendo-switch-free-download-release-battle-royale/). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250827200300/https://www.polygon.com/nintendo-switch/2019/2/13/18224042/tetris-99-nintendo-switch-free-download-release-battle-royale/) from the original on August 27, 2025. Retrieved August 3, 2025.
129. Singletary, Charles (July 16, 2019). "*Tetris Effect*, No Longer a PS4 Exclusive, Hits Epic Games Store with VR support" (https://www.digitaltrends.com/news/tetris-effect-pc-release-epic-games-store-vr-support/). *Digital Trends*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250722062726/https://www.digitaltrends.com/news/tetris-effect-pc-release-epic-games-store-vr-support/) from the original on July 22, 2025. Retrieved August 3, 2025.
130. Oxford, Nadia (January 10, 2020). "*Tetris 99*'s Biggest Fan Is The Father of Tetris Himself, Alexey Pajitnov" (https://www.vg247.com/tetris-99s-biggest-fan-is-the-father-of-tetris-himself-alexey-pajitnov). *USGamer*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240907001323/https://www.vg247.com/tetris-99s-biggest-fan-is-the-father-of-tetris-himself-alexey-pajitnov) from the original on September 7, 2024. Retrieved August 3, 2025 – via VG247.
131. "*Puyo Puyo Tetris*" (https://www.metacritic.com/game/nintendo-switch/puyo-puyo-tetris). *Metacritic*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241208032731/https://www.metacritic.com/game/puyo-puyo-tetris/) from the original on December 8, 2024. Retrieved January 31, 2025.
132. Hosoyamada, Mizuki (November 19, 2020). "*Puyo Puyo Tetris 2* Interview: Producer Mizuki Hosoyamada on Sequels, 'Manzai Demos' and More" (https://www.siliconera.com/puyo-puyo-tetris-2-interview-producer-mizuki-hosoyamada-on-sequels-manzai-demos-and-more/). *Siliconera* (Interview). Interviewed by Graham Russel. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20160504052024/http://www.playstationlifestyle.net/2014/02/12/japanese-sales-charts-ps-vita-terraria-debuts-on-vita/) from the original on May 4, 2016. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
133. Byrd, Christopher (November 28, 2018). "*Tetris* Becomes Even More Addictive in *Tetris Effect*" (https://www.washingtonpost.com/arts-entertainment/2018/11/28/tetris-becomes-even-more-addictive-tetris-effect/). *Washington Post*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20181128203707/https://www.washingtonpost.com/arts-entertainment/2018/11/28/tetris-becomes-even-more-addictive-tetris-effect/) from the original on November 28, 2018. Retrieved February 2, 2025.
134. Holt, Kris (September 17, 2018). "*Tetris Effect* Drops a Color Bomb on Your PS4 November 9th" (https://www.engadget.com/2018-09-17-tetris-effect-release-date.html). *Engadget*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20201109013555/https://www.engadget.com/2018-09-17-tetris-effect-release-date.html) from the original on November 9, 2020. Retrieved February 2, 2025.
135. Hall, Charlie (July 23, 2019). "*Tetris Effect* for PS4 Discounted, Out Now on PC" (https://www.polygon.com/ps4/2019/7/23/20707102/tetris-effect-ps4-discount-price-sale). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190723160441/https://www.polygon.com/ps4/2019/7/23/20707102/tetris-effect-ps4-discount-price-sale) from the original on July 23, 2019. Retrieved February 2, 2025.
136. Knezevic, Kevin (August 11, 2021). "*Tetris Effect*: Connected Coming to Nintendo Switch on October 8" (https://www.gamespot.com/articles/tetris-effect-connected-coming-to-nintendo-switch-on-october-8/1100-6495048/). *GameSpot*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230927010039/https://www.gamespot.com/articles/tetris-effect-connected-coming-to-nintendo-switch-on-october-8/1100-6495048/) from the original on September 27, 2023. Retrieved November 20, 2024.

137. Soto, Fran (January 20, 2023). "*Tetris Effect*: Connected Comes to PS5 with PSVR2 Compatibility" (https://hardcoregamer.com/news/tetris-effect-connected-comes-to-ps5-with-psvr2-compatibility/436098/). *Hardcore Gamer*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250126014128/https://hardcoregamer.com/news/tetris-effect-connected-comes-to-ps5-with-psvr2-compatibility/436098/) from the original on January 26, 2025. Retrieved November 20, 2024.
138. Alexander, Julia (February 13, 2019). "*Tetris* is Now a Battle Royale Game with *Tetris 99*" (https://www.theverge.com/2019/2/13/18224020/tetris-99-battle-royale-nintendo-switch-fortnite). *The Verge*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190214123830/https://www.theverge.com/2019/2/13/18224020/tetris-99-battle-royale-nintendo-switch-fortnite) from the original on February 14, 2019. Retrieved February 3, 2025.
139. Craddock, Ryan (June 28, 2019). "*Tetris 99* Will Soon Have a Tetris Battle Royale Rival" (https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2019/06/tetris_99_will_soon_have_a_tetris_battle_royale_rival). *Nintendo Life*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240603100705/https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2019/06/tetris_99_will_soon_have_a_tetris_battle_royale_rival) from the original on June 3, 2024. Retrieved February 3, 2025.
140. Doolan, Liam (April 25, 2019). "9.8 Million Switch Owners Have Signed Up to the Online Service and 2.8 Million Have Played *Tetris 99*" (https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2019/04/9_8_million_switch_owners_have_signed_up_to_the_online_service_and_2_8_million_have_played_tetris_99). *Nintendo Life*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241217213015/https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2019/04/9_8_million_switch_owners_have_signed_up_to_the_online_service_and_2_8_million_have_played_tetris_99) from the original on December 17, 2024. Retrieved December 7, 2024.
141. Fisher, Christine (January 22, 2020). "EA is Shutting Down its Mobile *Tetris* Games" (https://www.engadget.com/2020-01-22-ea-tetris-mobile-game.html). *Engadget*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20200123144654/https://www.engadget.com/2020-01-22-ea-tetris-mobile-game.html) from the original on January 23, 2020. Retrieved April 29, 2020.
142. Gartenberg, Chalm (January 23, 2020). "*Tetris* Returns to Android and iOS after EA's Version Shuts Down" (https://www.theverge.com/2020/1/23/21078481/tetris-n3twork-android-ios-new-apps-ea-shutdown-puzzle-game). *The Verge*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250830183729/https://www.theverge.com/2020/1/23/21078481/tetris-n3twork-android-ios-new-apps-ea-shutdown-puzzle-game) from the original on August 30, 2025. Retrieved August 3, 2025.
143. Orr, Aaron (November 30, 2021). "Playstudios Acquires Exclusive Rights to Develop *Tetris* Mobile Games" (https://www.pocketgamer.biz/playstudios-exclusive-rightstetris-mobile-games/). *PocketGamer.biz*. Retrieved August 3, 2025.
144. Broadwell, Josh (March 28, 2023). "Mobile Game Maker Wants to Give You Things for Playing *Tetris*" (https://ftw.usatoday.com/story/tech/gaming/2023/03/28/playstudios-tetris-mobile-game-rewards-program/81162939007/). *USA Today*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250901064424/https://ftw.usatoday.com/story/tech/gaming/2023/03/28/playstudios-tetris-mobile-game-rewards-program/81162939007/) from the original on September 1, 2025. Retrieved August 3, 2025.
145. Webster, Andrew (November 11, 2024). "Video Game History Falls into Place in *Tetris Forever*" (https://www.theverge.com/2024/11/11/24291537/tetris-forever-review-ps5-switch-pc-xbox). *The Verge*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250725073054/https://www.theverge.com/2024/11/11/24291537/tetris-forever-review-ps5-switch-pc-xbox) from the original on July 25, 2025. Retrieved August 9, 2025.
146. "*Tetris Forever*" (https://www.metacritic.com/game/tetris-forever). *Metacritic*. Retrieved August 9, 2025.

147. Doolan, Liam (November 11, 2024). "Round Up: The Reviews Are In for *Tetris Forever*" (https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2024/11/round-up-the-reviews-are-in-for-tetris-forever). *Nintendo Life*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250605062300/https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2024/11/round-up-the-reviews-are-in-for-tetris-forever) from the original on June 5, 2025. Retrieved August 9, 2025.
148. Pajitnov & Rogers 2023, 3:40-3:43.
149. "Most Ported Computer Game" (https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/most-ported-computer-game). *Guinness World Records*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250829084832/https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/most-ported-computer-game) from the original on August 29, 2025. Retrieved July 15, 2025.
150. "Most Variants of a Videogame" (https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/86503-most-official-and-unofficial-variants-in-a-videogame). *Guinness World Records*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240115121829/https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/86503-most-official-and-unofficial-variants-in-a-videogame) from the original on January 15, 2024. Retrieved January 15, 2024.
151. Leone, Matt (2014). "*Tetris Ultimate*: Making *Tetris* into a Virtual Sport" (https://www.polygon.com/a/e3-2014/tetris-ultimate). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241229231003/https://www.polygon.com/a/e3-2014/tetris-ultimate) from the original on December 29, 2024. Retrieved December 29, 2024.
152. Plank 2022, pp. 271–272.
153. Pajitnov & Rogers 2023, 6:19–6:48.
154. Linneman 2018, 31:24–31:34.
155. Pajitnov & Rogers 2023, 3:10.
156. Plank-Blasko, Dana (October 2015). " 'From Russia with Fun!': *Tetris*, Korobeiniki and the Ludic Soviet" (https://intellectdiscover.com/content/journals/10.1386/st.8.1-2.7_1). *The Soundtrack*. **8** (1–2): 7–24. doi:10.1386/st.8.1-2.7_1 (https://doi.org/10.1386%2Fst.8.1-2.7_1). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240710081002/https://intellectdiscover.com/content/journals/10.1386/st.8.1-2.7_1) from the original on July 10, 2024. Retrieved November 15, 2024.
157. Gibbons, William (Spring 2009). "Blip, Bloop, Bach? Some Uses of Classical Music on the Nintendo Entertainment System" (https://www.jstor.org/stable/10.5406/musimoviimag.2.1.0040). *Music and the Moving Image*. **2** (1): 40–52. doi:10.5406/musimoviimag.2.1.0040 (https://doi.org/10.5406%2Fmusimoviimag.2.1.0040). JSTOR 10.5406/musimoviimag.2.1.0040 (https://www.jstor.org/stable/10.5406/musimoviimag.2.1.0040). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240107053446/https://www.jstor.org/stable/10.5406/musimoviimag.2.1.0040) from the original on January 7, 2024. Retrieved November 15, 2024.
158. Plank 2022, p. 269.
159. Ackerman 2016, p. 97.
160. McGowan, Chris; McCullaugh, Jim (1995). *Entertainment in the Cyber Zone* (https://archive.org/details/bwb_P5-BRC-671/page/84/mode/2up). New York: Random House. p. 84. ISBN 978-0-679-75804-4 – via Internet Archive.
161. "*Tetris* By The Numbers" (https://tetris.com/by-the-numbers). *The Tetris Company*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241206233755/https://tetris.com/by-the-numbers) from the original on December 6, 2024. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
162. Temple 2004, 51:23.
163. "US Platinum Game Chart" (https://web.archive.org/web/20070421003854/http://www.the-magicbox.com/Chart-USPlatinum.shtml). *The Magic Box*. Archived from the original (http://www.the-magicbox.com/Chart-USPlatinum.shtml) on April 21, 2007. Retrieved December 5, 2024.

164. "H2O Announces *Tetrisphere* Sales" (https://web.archive.org/web/20000304054215/http://headline.gamespot.com/news/98_05/14_sphere/index.html). *GameSpot*. May 14, 1998. Archived from the original (http://headline.gamespot.com/news/98_05/14_sphere/index.html) on March 4, 2000. Retrieved February 7, 2025.
165. Keiser, Joe (August 2, 2006). "The Century's Top 50 Handheld Games" (https://web.archive.org/web/20071010052300/http://www.next-gen.biz/index2.php?option=com_content&task=view&id=3557&Itemid=2&pop=1&page=0). *Next Generation*. Archived from the original (http://www.next-gen.biz/index2.php?option=com_content&task=view&id=3557&Itemid=2&pop=1&page=0) on October 10, 2007. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
166. Campbell, Colin; Keiser, Joe (July 29, 2006). "The Top 100 Games of the 21st Century" (https://web.archive.org/web/20071028115051/http://www.next-gen.biz/index2.php?option=com_content&task=view&id=3537&Itemid=2&pop=1&page=1). *Next Generation*. Archived from the original (http://www.next-gen.biz/index2.php?option=com_content&task=view&id=3537&Itemid=2&pop=1&page=1) on October 28, 2007. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
167. Casamassina, Matt (July 25, 2007). "Nintendo Sales Update" (https://www.ign.com/articles/2007/07/25/nintendo-sales-update). *IGN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20190922174058/https://www.ign.com/articles/2007/07/25/nintendo-sales-update) from the original on September 22, 2019. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
168. Romano, Sal (February 25, 2021). "Famitsu Sales: 10/14/24 – 10/20/24 [Update]" (https://www.gematsu.com/2021/02/famitsu-sales-2-15-21-2-21-21). *Gematsu*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20210225174134/https://www.gematsu.com/2021/02/famitsu-sales-2-15-21-2-21-21) from the original on February 25, 2021. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
169. Romano, Sal (October 24, 2024). "Famitsu Sales: 10/14/24 – 10/20/24 [Update]" (https://www.gematsu.com/2024/10/famitsu-sales-10-14-24-10-20-24). *Gematsu*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241110111203/https://www.gematsu.com/2024/10/famitsu-sales-10-14-24-10-20-24) from the original on November 10, 2024. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
170. Spencer, Spanner (January 21, 2010). "*Tetris* is the Most Popular Mobile Game Ever: 100 million Paid Downloads since 2005" (https://www.pocketgamer.biz/tetris-is-the-most-popular-mobile-game-ever-100-million-paid-downloads-since-2005/). *PocketGamer.biz*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250121002046/https://www.pocketgamer.biz/tetris-is-the-most-popular-mobile-game-ever-100-million-paid-downloads-since-2005/) from the original on January 21, 2025. Retrieved December 14, 2024.
171. Rogers, Henk (April 7, 2014). " 'Mr. Tetris' Explains Why the Puzzle Game is Still Popular after Three Decades" (https://venturebeat.com/games/mr-tetris-explains-why-the-puzzle-game-is-still-popular-after-three-decades-interview/). *VentureBeat* (Interview). Interviewed by Dean Takahashi. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20231026020856/https://venturebeat.com/games/mr-tetris-explains-why-the-puzzle-game-is-still-popular-after-three-decades-interview/) from the original on October 26, 2023. Retrieved August 25, 2024.
172. Corriea, Alexa Ray (April 8, 2014). "*Tetris* has Passed 425 Million Downloads on Mobile, Not Including Free-to-Play" (https://www.polygon.com/2014/4/8/5594314/tetris-has-passed-425-million-downloads-on-mobile-not-including-free). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20210308145726/https://www.polygon.com/2014/4/8/5594314/tetris-has-passed-425-million-downloads-on-mobile-not-including-free) from the original on March 8, 2021. Retrieved August 25, 2024.
173. Gerken, Tom (October 16, 2023). "*Minecraft* Becomes First Video Game to Hit 300m Sales" (https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-67105983). *BBC*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240823203213/https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-67105983) from the original on August 23, 2024. Retrieved August 25, 2024.

174. Nguyen, Britney (October 16, 2023). "*Minecraft* Just Surpassed 300 Million Sales—Here's the Only Video Game Still Beating it" (https://www.forbes.com/sites/britneynguyen/2023/10/16/minecraft-just-surpassed-300-million-sales-heres-the-only-video-game-still-beating-it/). *Forbes*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240826003655/https://www.forbes.com/sites/britneynguyen/2023/10/16/minecraft-just-surpassed-300-million-sales-heres-the-only-video-game-still-beating-it/) from the original on August 26, 2024. Retrieved August 25, 2024.
175. Barr, Kyle (October 16, 2023). "*Minecraft* is the Highest-Selling Game of All Time, Behind *Tetris*" (https://gizmodo.com/minecraft-highest-selling-game-all-time-behind-tetris-1850929214). *Gizmondo*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241007222403/https://gizmodo.com/minecraft-highest-selling-game-all-time-behind-tetris-1850929214) from the original on October 7, 2024. Retrieved August 25, 2024.
176. Linneman 2018, 11:10–11:13.
177. McFerran, Damien (June 14, 2024). "The Most Famous Version of *Tetris* Is 35 Today" (https://web.archive.org/web/20241218204612/https://www.timeextension.com/news/2024/06/anniversary-the-most-famous-version-of-tetris-is-35-today). *TimeExtension*. Archived from the original (https://www.timeextension.com/news/2024/06/anniversary-the-most-famous-version-of-tetris-is-35-today) on December 18, 2024. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
178. Levy, Steven (December 1988). "The Game Hall of Fame" (https://archive.org/details/MacWorld_8812_December_1988/page/n127/mode/2up). *Macworld*. Vol. 5, no. 12. p. 124 – via Internet Archive.
179. "The 1989 *Compute!* Choice Awards" (https://archive.org/stream/1989-01-compute-magazine/Compute_Issue_104_1989_Jan#page/n25/mode/2up). *Compute!*. January 1989. p. 24. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20140316200847/https://archive.org/stream/1989-01-compute-magazine/Compute_Issue_104_1989_Jan#page/n25/mode/2up) from the original on March 16, 2014. Retrieved November 10, 2013.
180. Strauss, Bob (November 22, 1991). "Video Games Guide" (https://ew.com/article/1991/11/22/video-games-guide/). *Entertainment Weekly*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20170219184932/http://ew.com/article/1991/11/22/video-games-guide/) from the original on February 19, 2017. Retrieved September 9, 2018.
181. Ackerman 2016, p. 6.
182. "Top 100 Video Games" (https://archive.org/details/flux-issue-4/page/n27/mode/2up). *Flux*. No. 4. April 1995. p. 28 – via Internet Archive.
183. "Top 100 Games of All Time". *Next Generation*. No. 21. September 1996. p. 71.
184. "Top 50 Games of All Time". *Next Generation*. No. 50. February 1999. p. 81.
185. "100 Best Games of All Time". *Electronic Gaming Monthly*. No. 100. November 1997. p. 160.
186. "The 100 Games of the Millennium - 39. *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20000612005703/http://www.gamespot.co.uk/pc.gamespot/features/gotm_uk/39.html). *GameSpot*. January 2, 2000. Archived from the original (http://www.gamespot.co.uk/pc.gamespot/features/gotm_uk/39.html) on June 12, 2000. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
187. Cork, Jeff (November 16, 2009). "*Game Informer*'s Top 100 Games of All Time (Circa Issue 100)" (https://www.gameinformer.com/b/features/archive/2009/11/16/game-informer-s-top-100-games-of-all-time-circa-issue-100.aspx). *Game Informer*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20100408113757/http://gameinformer.com/b/features/archive/2009/11/16/game-informer-s-top-100-games-of-all-time-circa-issue-100.aspx) from the original on April 8, 2010. Retrieved December 10, 2013.
188. The *Game Informer* staff (December 2009). "The Top 200 Games of All Time". *Game Informer*. No. 200. pp. 44–79.
189. "*IGN* Top 100 Games of All Time" (https://web.archive.org/web/20131107133844/http://top100.ign.com/2007/ign_top_game_2.html). *IGN*. Archived from the original (http://top100.ign.com/2007/ign_top_game_2.html) on November 7, 2013. Retrieved November 22, 2012.

190. Sullivan, Meghan (December 31, 2021). "The Top 100 Video Games of All Time - 28. *Tetris*" (https://www.ign.com/articles/the-best-100-video-games-of-all-time). *IGN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20211231162533/https://www.ign.com/articles/the-best-100-video-games-of-all-time) from the original on December 31, 2021. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
191. "All-Time 100 Video Games - *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20160313221840/http://techland.time.com/2012/11/15/all-time-100-video-games/slide/tetris-1984/). *Time*. November 15, 2012. Archived from the original (http://techland.time.com/2012/11/15/all-time-100-video-games/slide/tetris-1984/) on March 13, 2016. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
192. "The 50 Best Video Games of All Time" (https://time.com/4458554/best-video-games-all-time/). *Time*. August 23, 2016. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180924045255/http://time.com/4458554/best-video-games-all-time/) from the original on September 24, 2018. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
193. "The 100 Best Games Ever" (https://web.archive.org/web/20150319223433/http://www.gamesradar.com/best-games-ever/). *GamesRadar+*. February 25, 2015. Archived from the original (http://www.gamesradar.com/best-games-ever/) on March 19, 2015. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
194. "The 50 Best Games of All Time" (https://www.gamesradar.com/best-games-of-all-time/). *GamesRadar+*. November 23, 2021. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20211124001852/https://www.gamesradar.com/best-games-of-all-time/) from the original on November 24, 2021. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
195. "The 500 Best Games of All Time: 100–1" (https://www.polygon.com/features/2017/12/1/16707720/the-500-best-games-of-all-time-100-1). *Polygon*. December 1, 2017. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20171201191206/https://www.polygon.com/features/2017/12/1/16707720/the-500-best-games-of-all-time-100-1) from the original on December 1, 2017. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
196. "The 100 Best Video Games of All Time, Ranked" (https://ftw.usatoday.com/lists/best-video-games). *USA Today*. September 10, 2022. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20220910130936/https://ftw.usatoday.com/lists/best-video-games) from the original on September 10, 2022. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
197. "A Definitive Ranking of the Top 30 Video Games of All Time" (https://ftw.usatoday.com/lists/best-video-games-all-time-list-zelda-mario). *USA Today*. January 26, 2024. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240128103906/https://ftw.usatoday.com/lists/best-video-games-all-time-list-zelda-mario) from the original on January 28, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
198. Pebble, Lucy (February 26, 2023). "20 Best Video Games of All Time — 4. *Tetris*" (https://www.thetimes.com/article/20-best-video-games-of-all-time-ranked-by-an-expert-jury-l5zgrxmw8). *The Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241009184503/https://www.thetimes.com/article/20-best-video-games-of-all-time-ranked-by-an-expert-jury-l5zgrxmw8) from the original on October 9, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
199. "The 100 Greatest Video Games of All Time, Ranked by Experts" (https://www.gq-magazine.co.uk/article/best-video-games-all-time). *GQ*. May 10, 2023. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230510142624/https://www.gq-magazine.co.uk/article/best-video-games-all-time) from the original on May 10, 2023. Retrieved May 10, 2023.
200. "The 50 Best Games Ever!". *PC Format*. No. 1. October 1991. pp. 109–111.
201. "The 15 Most Innovative Computer Games" (http://www.cgwmuseum.org/galleries/index.php?year=1996&pub=2&id=148). *Computer Gaming World*. November 1996. p. 102. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20160408023915/http://cgwmuseum.org/galleries/index.php?year=1996&pub=2&id=148) from the original on April 8, 2016. Retrieved March 25, 2016.
202. "The Top 25 Videogame Franchises" (https://www.ign.com/articles/2006/12/05/the-top-25-videogame-franchises). *IGN*. December 4, 2006. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20080226223358/http://ps3.ign.com/articles/749/749069p4.html) from the original on February 26, 2008. Retrieved January 2, 2024.

203. Jasper, Gavin (May 27, 2024). "35 Best Video Game Franchises Ever: 22. *Tetris*" (https://www.denofgeek.com/games/35-best-video-game-franchises-ever/). *Den of Geek*. Retrieved January 2, 2024.
204. Fatt, Boba (April 25, 2007). "The 52 Most Important Video Games of All Time (Page 4 of 8)" (https://web.archive.org/web/20080913085022/http://www.gamepro.com/article/features/110068/the-52-most-important-video-games-of-all-time-page-4-of-8/). *GamePro*. Archived from the original (http://www.gamepro.com/article/features/110068/the-52-most-important-video-games-of-all-time-page-4-of-8/) on September 13, 2008. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
205. Geddes, Ryan; Hatfield, Daemon (December 10, 2007). "*IGN*'s Top 10 Most Influential Games" (https://www.ign.com/articles/2007/12/11/igns-top-10-most-influential-games). *IGN*. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
206. Parish, Jeremy (2010). "Essential 50: *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20121104160239/http://www.1up.com/features/essential-50-tetris). *1Up.com*. Archived from the original (http://www.1up.com/features/essential-50-tetris) on November 4, 2012. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
207. Loveridge, Sam (April 12, 2013). "The 50 Most Important Games of All Time" (https://www.gamesradar.com/50-most-important-games-all-time/3/). *GamesRadar+*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241204102214/https://www.gamesradar.com/50-most-important-games-all-time/3/) from the original on December 4, 2024. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
208. Stuart, Keith (May 16, 2017). "The 10 Most Influential Video Games of All Time – In Pictures" (https://www.theguardian.com/technology/gallery/2017/may/16/the-10-most-influential-video-games-of-all-time). *The Guardian*. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
209. "Hall of Fame — New Inductees: *Tetris* (Spectrum Holobyte 1988)" (https://archive.org/details/Computer_Gaming_World_Issue_177/). *Computer Gaming World*. No. 177. April 1999. p. 237 – via Internet Archive.
210. "The *Gamespy* Hall of Fame - *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20040706010318/http://archive.gamespy.com/legacy/halloffame/tetris_a.shtm). *Gamespy*. July 2000. Archived from the original (http://archive.gamespy.com/legacy/halloffame/tetris_a.shtm) on July 6, 2004. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
211. "They'll Keep Playing It Long After All of Us Are Dead" (https://web.archive.org/web/20081209081517/http://www.gamespot.com/gamespot/features/all/greatestgames/p-8.html). *GameSpot*. July 2, 2003. Archived from the original (http://www.gamespot.com/gamespot/features/all/greatestgames/p-8.html) on December 9, 2008. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
212. "*IGN* Hall of Fame - *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20110506042038/http://games.ign.com/halloffame/tetris.html). 2007. Archived from the original (http://games.ign.com/halloffame/tetris.html) on May 6, 2011. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
213. Remo, Chris (February 13, 2007). "GDCA to Honor Miyamoto, Pajitnov, 'The Fat Man' Sanger, Costikyan" (https://www.shacknews.com/article/45731/gdca-to-honor-miyamoto-pajitnov). *Shacknews*. Retrieved August 1, 2025.
214. "Archive: 7th Annual Game Developers Choice Awards" (https://gamechoiceawards.com/archive-gdca-2007/). *Game Developers Choice Award*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250622181021/https://gamechoiceawards.com/archive-gdca-2007/) from the original on June 22, 2025. Retrieved August 1, 2025.
215. Chaplin, Heather (March 12, 2007). "Is That Just Some Game? No, It's a Cultural Artifact" (https://www.nytimes.com/2007/03/12/arts/design/12vide.html?ex=1331352000&en=380fc9bb18694da5&ei=5124&partner=permalink&exprod=permalink). *The New York Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20151204212137/http://www.nytimes.com/2007/03/12/arts/design/12vide.html?ex=1331352000&en=380fc9bb18694da5&ei=5124&partner=permalink&exprod=permalink) from the original on December 4, 2015. Retrieved November 1, 2013.

216. Ransom-Wiley, James. "10 Most Important Video Games of All Time, As Judged By 2 Designers, 2 Academics, and 1 Lowly Blogger" (https://web.archive.org/web/20140422035847/http://www.joystiq.com/2007/03/12/10-most-important-video-games-of-all-time-as-judged-by-2-design/). *Joystiq*. Archived from the original (http://www.joystiq.com/2007/03/12/10-most-important-video-games-of-all-time-as-judged-by-2-design/) on April 22, 2014.
217. Moore, Bo (May 30, 2013). "'All Hell Broke Loose': Why MoMA Is Exhibiting *Tetris* and *Pac-Man*" (https://www.wired.com/2013/05/moma-video-games/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20150908160501/http://www.theguardian.com/technology/gamesblog/2013/mar/01/video-games-art-moma-exhibition) from the original on September 8, 2015. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
218. "*Pong* and *Doom* Enter First Video Game Hall of Fame" (https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-33005297). *BBC*. June 4, 2015. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180703135721/https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-33005297) from the original on July 3, 2018. Retrieved December 2, 2024.
219. Kindy, David (July 29, 2019). "Thirty Years Ago, Game Boy Changed the Way America Played Video Games" (https://www.smithsonianmag.com/innovation/thirty-years-ago-game-boy-changed-way-america-played-video-games-180972743/). *Smithsonian Magazine*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20241203235816/https://www.smithsonianmag.com/innovation/thirty-years-ago-game-boy-changed-way-america-played-video-games-180972743/) from the original on December 3, 2024. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
220. Goldberg 2011, p. 87.
221. Ackerman 2016, pp. 226–228.
222. Brown, Tracy (March 31, 2023). "What Makes *Tetris* 'The Perfect Game'? Experts Break Down an Addictive Classic" (https://web.archive.org/web/20250830003735/https://www.latimes.com/entertainment-arts/movies/story/2023-03-31/tetris-apple-tv-movie-game-perfect-addictive). *The Los Angeles Times*. Archived from the original (https://www.latimes.com/entertainment-arts/movies/story/2023-03-31/tetris-apple-tv-movie-game-perfect-addictive) on August 30, 2025. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
223. Dillon, Roberto (2011). *The Golden Age of Video Games: The Birth of a Multi-Billion Dollar Industry* (https://archive.org/details/goldenageofvideo0000dill/). CRC Press. pp. 164–165. ISBN 978-1-4398-7323-6 – via Internet Archive.
224. Takahashi, Dean (June 1, 2009). "After 25 Years, *Tetris* Has Sold 125 million Copies" (https://venturebeat.com/entrepreneur/after-25-years-tetris-has-sold-125-million-copies/). *Venture Beat*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230621144138/https://venturebeat.com/entrepreneur/after-25-years-tetris-has-sold-125-million-copies/) from the original on June 21, 2023. Retrieved December 3, 2024.
225. Byrd, Matthew (April 26, 2024). "The Games That Defined the Nintendo Game Boy" (https://www.denofgeek.com/games/games-that-defined-the-nintendo-game-boy/). *Den of Geek*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250723112023/https://www.denofgeek.com/games/games-that-defined-the-nintendo-game-boy/) from the original on July 23, 2025. Retrieved July 30, 2025.
226. Crookes, David (September 2013). "Brain Strain: A Bluffler's Guide to Puzzle Games". *Retro Gamer*. No. 119. pp. 38–45.
227. Faber, Tom (September 7, 2021). "Tetris — How a Game of Logic Took Over Our Minds" (https://www.ft.com/content/3c6d8cae-d22b-465d-982d-981c6477582f). *Financial Times*. Retrieved December 4, 2024.
228. Kohler, Chris (June 4, 2009). "*Tetris* Turns 25, and It's Still an Addictive Pleasure" (https://www.wired.com/2009/06/tetris/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240430061158/https://www.wired.com/2009/06/tetris/) from the original on April 30, 2024. Retrieved December 4, 2024.

229. Juul, Jesper (2010). *A Casual Revolution: Reinventing Video Games and Their Players* (https://archive.org/details/casualrevolution0000juul/). Cambridge, Massachusetts: MIT Press. p. 27. ISBN 9780262013376 – via Internet Archive.
230. Loguidice & Barton 2009, p. 291.
231. Loguidice & Barton 2009, p. 296.
232. Loguidice & Barton 2009, p. 296–297.
233. Ackerman 2016, p. 242–243.
234. Garber, Megan (June 6, 2014). "*Tetris* Is 30 Years Old Today" (https://www.theatlantic.com/technology/archive/2014/06/tetris-is-30-years-old-today/372356/). *The Atlantic*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240327053620/https://www.theatlantic.com/technology/archive/2014/06/tetris-is-30-years-old-today/372356/) from the original on March 27, 2024. Retrieved July 25, 2025.
235. Goldberg 2011, p. 88.
236. Minotti, Mike (June 24, 2014). "*Tetris* Back in the Record Books for 29-Story Game" (https://web.archive.org/web/20230626013556/https://venturebeat.com/games/tetris-back-in-the-record-books-for-29-story-game/). *VentureBeat*. Archived from the original (https://venturebeat.com/games/tetris-back-in-the-record-books-for-29-story-game/) on June 26, 2023. Retrieved December 2, 2024.
237. Diver, Mike (November 12, 2017). "Revisiting Nintendo's Novelty Pop Hit" (https://www.eurogamer.net/revisiting-nintendos-novelty-pop-hit). *Eurogamer*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20201111224706/https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2017-11-12-revisiting-nintendos-novelty-pop-hit) from the original on November 11, 2020. Retrieved December 2, 2024.
238. Ackerman 2016, p. 73.
239. McCluskey, Megan (March 31, 2023). "The Complicated True Story Behind Apple TV+'s *Tetris* Movie" (https://time.com/6266810/tetris-movie-apple-tv-true-story/). *Time*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240227090730/https://time.com/6266810/tetris-movie-apple-tv-true-story/) from the original on February 27, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
240. Goldsmith, Jeffrey (May 1, 1994). "This Is Your Brain on *Tetris*" (https://www.wired.com/1994/05/tetris-2/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20221122022558/https://www.wired.com/1994/05/tetris-2/) from the original on November 22, 2022. Retrieved November 22, 2022.
241. Ackerman 2016, p. 77–78.
242. Welsh, Oli (August 9, 2023). "Tech Writer Sues Apple, Claiming *Tetris* Movie Ripped Off His 'Cold War Thriller' Book" (https://www.polygon.com/23825607/tetris-movie-apple-dan-ackerman-lawsuit). *Polygon*. Retrieved July 21, 2025.
243. Ackerman 2016, p. 247–249.
244. "*Tetris*" (https://www.metacritic.com/movie/tetris). *Metacritic*. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
245. D'Alessandro, Anthony (April 26, 2023). "Chris Evans & Ana de Armas Skydance Spy Action Pic *Ghosted* Earns Record Movie Debut for Apple TV+" (https://deadline.com/2023/04/chris-evans-ana-de-armas-ghosted-viewership-apple-tv-record-1235338734/). *Deadline Hollywood*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230921103522/https://deadline.com/2023/04/chris-evans-ana-de-armas-ghosted-viewership-apple-tv-record-1235338734/) from the original on September 21, 2023. Retrieved December 5, 2024.
246. Stanton, Rich (April 1, 2025). " 'The Original *Tetris* Was a Survival game': The Man who Prised *Tetris* Out of the Soviet System Recalls How Different It Once Was" (https://www.pcgamer.com/games/the-original-tetris-was-a-survival-game-the-man-who-prised-tetris-out-of-the-soviet-system-recalls-how-different-it-once-was/). *PC Magazine*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20250419115229/https://www.pcgamer.com/games/the-original-tetris-was-a-survival-game-the-man-who-prised-tetris-out-of-the-soviet-system-recalls-how-different-it-once-was/) from the original on April 19, 2025. Retrieved July 21, 2025.

247. Rogers, Henk (April 1, 2025). "The Life Story Behind *Tetris, The Perfect Game*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20250401143047/https://venturebeat.com/games/the-life-story-behind-tetris-the-perfect-game-henk-rogers-interview/). *Venture Beat* (Interview). Archived from the original (https://gamesbeat.com/the-life-story-behind-tetris-the-perfect-game-henk-rogers-interview/) on April 1, 2025. Retrieved July 21, 2025.
248. Welsh, Oli (December 3, 2024). "A Missing Piece of NES History Is Finally Coming to Switch" (https://web.archive.org/web/20250811035308/https://www.polygon.com/news/489871/nes-tetris-nintendo-switch-online-announcement/). *Polygon*. Archived from the original (https://www.polygon.com/news/489871/nes-tetris-nintendo-switch-online-announcement) on August 11, 2025. Retrieved December 4, 2024.
249. Schonbrun, Zach (December 28, 2021). "A New Generation Stacks Up Championships in an Old Game: *Tetris*" (https://www.nytimes.com/2021/12/28/sports/tetris-game.html). *The New York Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240117023131/https://www.nytimes.com/2021/12/28/sports/tetris-game.html) from the original on January 17, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
250. Karnadi, Chris (June 21, 2022). "Teens are Rewriting What is Possible in the World of Competitive *Tetris*" (https://www.polygon.com/23269073/competitive-classic-tetris-ctwc-jonas-neubauer-andy-michael-artiaga). *Polygon*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240115233118/https://www.polygon.com/23269073/competitive-classic-tetris-ctwc-jonas-neubauer-andy-michael-artiaga) from the original on January 15, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
251. Shaver, Morgan (March 31, 2023). "Why *Tetris* Consumed Your Brain" (https://www.nytimes.com/2023/03/31/movies/tetris-game-boy-nintendo.html). *The New York Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240409075702/https://www.nytimes.com/2023/03/31/movies/tetris-game-boy-nintendo.html) from the original on April 9, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
252. Korn, Jennifer (January 3, 2024). "Oklahoma Teenager Finally Defeats the Unbeatable Game: *Tetris*" (https://www.cnn.com/2024/01/03/tech/oklahoma-teenager-defeats-tetris/index.html). *CNN*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240709011234/https://www.cnn.com/2024/01/03/tech/oklahoma-teenager-defeats-tetris/index.html) from the original on July 9, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
253. Water cutter, Angela (January 5, 2024). "Why Everyone Is Obsessed with the Kid Who Beat *Tetris*" (https://www.wired.com/story/why-everyone-is-obsessed-with-the-kid-who-beat-tetris/). *Wired*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20240111042426/https://www.wired.com/story/why-everyone-is-obsessed-with-the-kid-who-beat-tetris/) from the original on January 11, 2024. Retrieved November 12, 2024.
254. Lindstedt, John K.; Gray, Wayne D. (March 12, 2015). "Meta-T: *Tetris* as an Experimental Paradigm for Cognitive Skills Research" (https://link.springer.com/article/10.3758/s13428-014-0547-y#Fn3). *Behavior Research Methods*. **47** (4): 945–965. doi:10.3758/s13428-014-0547-y (https://doi.org/10.3758%2Fs13428-014-0547-y). PMID 25761389 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/25761389). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20220122090625/https://link.springer.com/article/10.3758/s13428-014-0547-y#Fn3) from the original on January 22, 2022. Retrieved November 14, 2024.
255. Ackerman 2016, pp. 69–70.
256. Haier, R.J.; Siegel, B.V.; MacLachlan, A.; Soderling, E.; Lottenberg, S.; Buchsbaum, M.S. (January 1992). "Regional Glucose Metabolic Changes after Learning a Complex Visuospatial/Motor Task: A Positron Emission Tomographic Study". *Brain Research*. **570** (1–2): 134–43. doi:10.1016/0006-8993(92)90573-R (https://doi.org/10.1016%2F0006-8993%2892%2990573-R). PMID 1617405 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/1617405). S2CID 21725897 (https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:21725897).
257. Ackerman 2016, pp. 81–82.

258. Latham, Andrew J.; Patson, Lucy L. M.; Tippette, Lynette J. (September 13, 2013). "The Virtual Brain: 30 Years of Video-game Play and Cognitive Abilities" (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3772618). *Frontiers in Psychology*. **4**: 629. doi:10.3389/fpsyg.2013.00629 (https://doi.org/10.3389%2Ffpsyg.2013.00629). PMC 3772618 (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3772618). PMID 24062712 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24062712).
259. Agren, Thomas; Hoppe, Johanna M.; Singh, Laura; Holmes, Emily A.; Rosén, Jörgen (August 2, 2021). "The Neural Basis of *Tetris* Gameplay: Implicating the Role of Visuospatial Processing" (https://doi.org/10.1007%2Fs12144-021-02081-z). *Current Psychology*. **42** (10): 8156–8163. doi:10.1007/s12144-021-02081-z (https://doi.org/10.1007%2Fs12144-021-02081-z).
260. Timm, J. David; Huff, Markus; Schwan, Stephan; Papenmeier, Frank (February 22, 2024). "Short-term Transfer Effects of *Tetris* on Mental Rotation: Review and Registered Report — A Bayesian Approach" (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC11062957). *Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics*. **86** (3): 1056–1064. doi:10.3758/s13414-024-02855-0 (https://doi.org/10.3758%2Fs13414-024-02855-0). PMC 11062957 (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC11062957). PMID 38383915 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38383915).
261. Craig, Victoria Elizabeth Mabel; McLaughlin, Derek Francis; Devlin, Karen P.; Higgins, Aiveen; Boyle, Breidge (June 11, 2024). "Potential for Use of *Tetris* in the Neonatal Unit – A Scoping Review" (https://doi.org/10.1186%2Fs44247-024-00086-9). *BMC Digital Health*. **2** (34) 34. doi:10.1186/s44247-024-00086-9 (https://doi.org/10.1186%2Fs44247-024-00086-9).
262. Varma, Mohith M.; Zeng, Shengzi; Singh, Laura; Holmes, Emily A.; Huang, Jingyun; Chiu, Man Hey; Hu, Xiaoqing (August 21, 2024). "A Systematic Review and Meta-analysis of Experimental Methods for Modulating Intrusive Memories following Lab-analogue Trauma Exposure in Non-clinical Populations" (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC11493681). *Nature Human Behaviour*. **8** (10): 1968–1987. doi:10.1038/s41562-024-01956-y (https://doi.org/10.1038%2Fs41562-024-01956-y). PMC 11493681 (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC11493681). PMID 39169230 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/39169230).
263. Highfield, Julie; Iyadurai, Lalitha; Holmes, Emily A. (May 27, 2025). "A Summary Review of the Development of Using a Brief Imagery-competing Task Intervention (ICTI) for Reducing Intrusive Memories of Psychological Trauma: Applications in Healthcare Settings for Both Staff and Patients" (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC12116969). *Discover Mental Health*. **5** (78) 78. doi:10.1007/s44192-025-00205-6 (https://doi.org/10.1007%2Fs44192-025-00205-6). PMC 12116969 (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC12116969). PMID 40425895 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/40425895).
264. Ackerman 2016, p. 153.
265. Ackerman 2016, pp. 155–156.
266. Brzustowski, John (March 1992). *Can You Win at* Tetris*?* (https://open.library.ubc.ca/media/stream/pdf/831/1.0079748) (PDF) (Master of Science thesis). University of British Columbia. doi:10.14288/1.0079748 (https://doi.org/10.14288%2F1.0079748). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20220318064558/https://open.library.ubc.ca/media/stream/pdf/831/1.0079748) from the original on March 18, 2022. Retrieved October 16, 2013.
267. Ackerman 2016, p. 156.
268. Burgiel, Heidi (July 1997). "How to Lose at *Tetris*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20030513033006/http://www.geom.umn.edu/~burgiel/Tetris/tetris.PS). *The Mathematical Gazette*. **81** (491): 194–200. doi:10.2307/3619195 (https://doi.org/10.2307%2F3619195). JSTOR 3619195 (https://www.jstor.org/stable/3619195). Archived from the original (http://www.geom.umn.edu/%7Eburgiel/Tetris/tetris.PS) on May 13, 2003.
269. Ackerman 2016, pp. 153–154.

270. Demaine, Erik D.; Hohenberger, Susan; Liben-Nowell, David (July 25–28, 2003). Tetris *Is Hard, Even to Approximate* (http://erikdemaine.org/papers/Tetris_COCOON2003/paper.pdf) (PDF). Proceedings of the 9th International Computing and Combinatorics Conference (COCOON 2003) (https://web.archive.org/web/20120105042734/http://www.cs.montana.edu/bhz/cocoon03.html). Big Sky, Montana. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20100613201613/http://erikdemaine.org/papers/Tetris_COCOON2003/paper.pdf) (PDF) from the original on June 13, 2010. Retrieved December 18, 2009.
271. Lane, Matthew (2017). *Power-up: Unlocking the Hidden Mathematics in Video Games* (https://archive.org/details/powerupunlocking0000lane/). Princeton University Press. pp. 165–166. ISBN 9780691161518 – via Internet Archive.
272. Ackerman 2016, p. 159.

Bibliography

Books

- Ackerman, Dan (2016). *The Tetris Effect: The Game that Hypnotized the World* (https://archive.org/details/tetriseffectgame0000acke). New York: PublicAffairs. ISBN 978-1-61039-611-0. OCLC 943694339 (https://search.worldcat.org/oclc/943694339) – via Internet Archive.
- Donovan, Tristan (2010). "A Plane to Moscow" (https://archive.org/details/replayhistoryofv0000dono/page/198/mode/2up). *Replay: The History of Video Games*. East Sussex: Yellow Ant. pp. 199–211. ISBN 978-0-9565072-0-4 – via Internet Archive.
- Goldberg, Harold (2011). "Falling Blocks, Rising Fortunes" (https://archive.org/details/allyourbasearebe00gold_0/page/74/mode/2up). *All Your Base are Belong to Us*. New York: Three Rivers Press. pp. 74–89. ISBN 978-0-307-46355-5 – via Internet Archive.
- Kent, Steven L. (2001). "*Tetris*" (https://archive.org/details/ultimatehistoryo0000kent/page/377). *The Ultimate History of Video Games: From Pong to Pokémon and Beyond—The Story Behind the Craze That Touched Our Lives and Changed the World*. New York: Three Rivers Press. pp. 377–381. ISBN 978-0-7615-3643-7. OCLC 47254175 (https://search.worldcat.org/oclc/47254175) – via Internet Archive.
- Loguidice, Bill; Barton, Matt (2009). "*Tetris* (1985): Casual Gaming Falls Into Place" (https://archive.org/details/vintagegamesinsi0000logu/page/290). *Vintage Games: An Insider Look at the History of Grand Theft Auto, Super Mario, and the Most Influential Games of All Time*. Amsterdam: Focal Press. pp. 291–301. ISBN 978-0-240-81146-8 – via Internet Archive.
- Plank, Dana (July 25, 2022). "*Tetris*". In Perron, Bernard; Boudreau, Kelly; Wolf, Mark J.P.; Arsenault, Dominic (eds.). *Fifty Key Video Games* (First ed.). New York: Routledge. pp. 268–274. doi:10.4324/9781003199205 (https://doi.org/10.4324%2F9781003199205). ISBN 978-1-003-19920-5.
- Sheff, David; Eddy, Andy (1999). "From Russia With Love" (https://archive.org/details/0966961706/page/295). *Game Over: Press Start to Continue*. Wilton, CT: GamePress. pp. 295–348. ISBN 978-0-966-96170-6. OCLC 1190934258 (https://search.worldcat.org/oclc/1190934258) – via Internet Archive.

External videos

Presentation by Dan Ackerman on *The Tetris Effect*, September 12, 2016 (https://www.c-span.org/video/?414688-1/the-tetris-effect), C-SPAN

Video documentaries

- Linneman, John (November 14, 2018). *DF Retro: Tetris!* (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cUeaanfiXmo&t=0). Digital Foundry. Retrieved December 7, 2024 – via YouTube.
- Pajitnov, Alexey; Rogers, Henk (April 26, 2023). *Unsolved Tetris Mysteries With Creator Alexy Pajitnov & Designer Henk Rogers* (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6YhkkyXydNI&t=0). Ars Technica. Retrieved December 7, 2024 – via YouTube.
- Temple, Magnus (2004). *Tetris: From Russia with Love*. BBC.

Further reading

- Gerasimov, Vadim. "Tetris Story" (https://vadim.oversigma.com/Tetris.htm). *OverSigma*.
- *The Creation of Tetris* (https://www.bbc.co.uk/programmes/p00mdqf8). *BBC World Service*. BBC. December 29, 2012.

External links

- Official website (https://tetris.com/)

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Tetris&oldid=1365597228"